SSC CGL 2026

GENERAL AWARENESS – MCQ BOOK

MCQs with Answers & Explanations

Part A: CGL 2026 reported questions (MCQ form) • Part B: chapter-wise practice MCQs on 2026 trend topics

Polity • History • Art & Culture • Economy • Geography • Physics • Chemistry • Biology • Static GK – static GS only, current affairs excluded

Part A questions are candidate-recalled (memory-based), not an official SSC paper. Part B MCQs are original practice questions written on the topics SSC asked in 2026 – they are not previous-year questions. All explanations are original.

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INTRODUCTION

How to Use This MCQ Book

How the Book Is Organised

- Part A (Chapter 1): questions reported by candidates from SSC CGL 2026 Tier-1 shifts (30 Sep – Oct 2026), rewritten as MCQs. Each one is marked [CGL 2026 REPORTED] in orange, with the date, shift and source at the end of the question. The question wording and the options are reconstructions; the official SSC options are not available.
- Part B (Chapters 2–10): original practice MCQs on the same static GS topics that SSC asked in 2026 (Articles and amendments, Five-Year Plans and 1991 reforms, North-East festivals, musicians, books, sports, units, optics, chemistry, biology). These are not previous-year questions.
- Every MCQ has the answer and a short explanation that teaches the surrounding concept, so one question covers several possible variations.
- Current affairs are excluded.

How to Practise

- Cover the answer line, attempt a block of 25 in 15 minutes (the 2026 sectional timer), then check.
- Mark the ones you got wrong and read only their explanations again after two days.
- SSC CGL 2026 Tier-1 GA: 25 questions, 50 marks, 15 minutes, −0.50 per wrong answer.

✔ **TOPPER TRICK:** In the real exam, attempt only the questions where you can eliminate at least two options. With −0.50 per wrong answer, blind guesses lose marks on average.

✖ **COMMON MISTAKE:** Part A items are memory-based (from Prepp, Examshortcut, PW, Career Power, Adda247, Testbook analyses). Check them against the official SSC answer key once it is released.

CHAPTER 1

Part A – CGL 2026 Reported Questions (MCQ Form)

1.1 Polity

Q1. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Which Article of the Constitution states that 'India, that is Bharat, shall be a Union of States'? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Article 1 (b) Article 2
(c) Article 3 (d) Article 4

Answer: (a) Article 1 opens Part I. 'Union of States' means the federation is not the result of an agreement among states and no state can secede. Article 2 admits new states from outside; Article 3 forms new states or alters boundaries within India.

Q2. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The right to move the Supreme Court for enforcement of Fundamental Rights is given by which Article? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW; 5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Article 19 (b) Article 21
(c) Article 32 (d) Article 226

Answer: (c) Article 32 is itself a Fundamental Right; Ambedkar called it the 'heart and soul' of the Constitution. The SC issues five writs under it. High Courts issue writs under Article 226, which also covers legal rights.

Q3. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Article 131A, which gave the Supreme Court exclusive jurisdiction over the validity of central laws, was inserted by which amendment? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut, PW]

(a) 24th Amendment (b) 42nd Amendment
(c) 44th Amendment (d) 52nd Amendment

Answer: (b) The 42nd Amendment (1976) inserted Articles 131A, 144A and 226A to curb High Courts' review of central laws. The 43rd Amendment (1977) omitted all three. Article 131 (Centre–state disputes) remains.

Q4. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Article 243 of the Constitution deals with: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut, PW]

(a) Definitions for Panchayats (Part IX) (b) Municipalities
(c) Co-operative societies (d) Scheduled Areas

Answer: (a) The 73rd Amendment (1992) added Part IX (Articles 243–243-O) and the Eleventh Schedule (29 subjects). Article 243A – Gram Sabha; 243D – reservation (≥ 1/3 for women); 243K – State Election Commission.

Q5. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The 97th Constitutional Amendment (2011) is related to: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Anti-defection
(b) Co-operative societies
(c) GST
(d) Right to education

Answer: (b) It added 'co-operative societies' to Article 19(1)(c), inserted Article 43B (DPSP) and Part IX-B (Articles 243ZH–243ZT). Anti-defection = 52nd; GST = 101st; Right to Education = 86th.

Q6. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Under which Article can the Rajya Sabha, by a two-thirds resolution, enable Parliament to create new All India Services? [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Article 249
(b) Article 312
(c) Article 315
(d) Article 368

Answer: (b) Article 312 – new All India Services (including an All India Judicial Service). Article 249 – Rajya Sabha resolution to let Parliament legislate on a State List subject. Article 315 – Public Service Commissions.

Q7. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Which Article provides for a financial emergency? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Article 352
(b) Article 356
(c) Article 360
(d) Article 365

Answer: (c) Article 360 – financial emergency; never declared so far. Article 352 – national emergency (1962, 1971, 1975). Article 356 – President's Rule. Article 365 – failure to comply with Union directions.

Q8. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Under the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, a 'zero FIR' means an FIR that: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut, PW]

(a) Has zero accused named
(b) Can be registered at any police station regardless of jurisdiction
(c) Is filed only online
(d) Is withdrawn within 24 hours

Answer: (b) Section 173 BNSS lets any police station register information on a cognisable offence and transfer it to the station with jurisdiction. BNS, BNSS and BSA replaced the IPC, CrPC and Evidence Act on 1 July 2024.

Q9. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 replaced which law? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Code of Criminal Procedure
(b) Indian Evidence Act
(c) Indian Penal Code
(d) Indian Police Act

Answer: (c) BNS replaced the IPC (1860); BNSS replaced the CrPC (1973); Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam replaced the Indian Evidence Act (1872). All came into force on 1 July 2024.

1.2 History & Culture

Q10. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Who founded the Mauryan Empire? [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Bindusara
(b) Ashoka
(c) Chandragupta Maurya
(d) Bimbisara

Answer: (c) Chandragupta Maurya (c. 321 BCE), guided by Chanakya, overthrew Dhanananda. He defeated Seleucus Nikator; Megasthenes wrote Indica. He died at Shravanabelagola as a Jain.

Q11. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] How many Mahapuranas are there? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) 4 (b) 6
(c) 18 (d) 108

Answer: (c) There are 18 Mahapuranas (and 18 Upapuranas). Matsya Purana is regarded as the oldest. The Mahabharata and the Bhagavad Gita also have 18 parvas/chapters.

Q12. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Fatawa-e-Alamgiri, a compilation of Islamic law, was prepared during the reign of: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Akbar (b) Jahangir
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Aurangzeb

Answer: (d) Compiled c. 1664–1672 by jurists led by Sheikh Nizamuddin Burhanpuri on Aurangzeb's (Alamgir's) orders, based on the Hanafi school.

Q13. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Taj Mahal was built by Shah Jahan in memory of: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Nur Jahan (b) Mumtaz Mahal
(c) Jodha Bai (d) Hamida Banu Begum

Answer: (b) Mumtaz Mahal (Arjumand Banu Begum). Built c. 1632–1653; chief architect Ustad Ahmad Lahori; Makrana marble; UNESCO site since 1983.

Q14. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Sati was abolished in 1829 by Regulation XVII under which Governor-General? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Lord Cornwallis (b) Lord William Bentinck
(c) Lord Dalhousie (d) Lord Canning

Answer: (b) Bentinck, supported by Raja Ram Mohan Roy, abolished sati on 4 December 1829. Widow Remarriage Act – 1856 (Canning, Vidyasagar).

Q15. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Kailasanatha temple at Kanchipuram was built by which dynasty? [1 Oct · Prepp – single source]

(a) Chola (b) Pallava
(c) Rashtrakuta (d) Chalukya

Answer: (b) Built by the Pallava king Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha), c. 700 CE. Don't confuse it with the Kailasa temple at Ellora (Cave 16), built by the Rashtrakuta king Krishna I.

Q16. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The umbrella-like structure at the top of a stupa is called: [5 Oct · Prepp; source's answer pairing unclear]

(a) Harmika (b) Anda
(c) Chhatra (d) Medhi

Answer: (c) Chhatra is the parasol on the yashti (mast). Harmika is the square railing on top of the anda (dome); medhi is the base drum.

Q17. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Bihu is the major festival of which state? [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) West Bengal (b) Assam
(c) Manipur (d) Odisha

Answer: (b) Three Bihus: Rongali/Bohag (April, New Year), Kati/Kongali (October), Bhogali/Magh (January, harvest).

Q18. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Chapchar Kut is celebrated in: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut, PW]

(a) Nagaland (b) Meghalaya
(c) Mizoram (d) Tripura

Answer: (c) Mizoram's spring festival, held after jhum clearing. Other Mizo festivals: Mim Kut and Pawl Kut.

Q19. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Cheraw, the bamboo dance, belongs to: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Mizoram (b) Assam
(c) Sikkim (d) Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: (a) Men clap bamboo poles in rhythm while women dance between them; performed at Chapchar Kut.

Q20. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Baul tradition of mystic minstrels belongs to: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Rajasthan (b) Bengal
(c) Punjab (d) Kerala

Answer: (b) Bauls of West Bengal and Bangladesh; Lalon Fakir; ektara; UNESCO intangible heritage list (2008).

Q21. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Which of the following is a folk dance of Odisha? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW topic]

(a) Ghumura (b) Garba
(c) Lavani (d) Giddha

Answer: (a) Ghumura (Kalahandi, drum dance). Also Dalkhai, Gotipua, Paika, Ranappa, Chhau (Mayurbhanj – no masks). Garba – Gujarat; Lavani – Maharashtra; Giddha – Punjab.

Q22. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Ustad Bismillah Khan is associated with: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Sarod (b) Sitar
(c) Shehnai (d) Tabla

Answer: (c) Shehnai maestro of Varanasi; played at the Red Fort on 15 August 1947; Bharat Ratna 2001.

Q23. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia is famous for playing the: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Santoor (b) Flute
(c) Sarangi (d) Veena

Answer: (b) Bansuri (flute). With santoor player Shivkumar Sharma he formed the 'Shiv–Hari' duo for film music.

1.3 Economy, Geography, Science

Q24. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Fiscal deficit of the government indicates: [30 Sep · Prepp Q46]

(a) Total borrowing requirement (b) Revenue expenditure minus revenue receipts
(c) Interest payments (d) Trade deficit

Answer: (a) Fiscal deficit = total expenditure − (revenue receipts + non-debt capital receipts) = borrowings. Revenue deficit = option (b). Primary deficit = fiscal deficit − interest payments.

Q25. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Net Domestic Product (NDP) equals: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) GDP + depreciation (b) GDP − depreciation
(c) GNP − net factor income from abroad (d) GDP + net indirect taxes

Answer: (b) NDP = GDP − depreciation (consumption of fixed capital). GNP = GDP + NFIA. National income = NNP at factor cost.

Q26. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] India's New Economic Policy of 1991 was introduced when the Finance Minister was: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut; 28 Oct · Testbook]

(a) Yashwant Sinha (b) Manmohan Singh
(c) P. Chidambaram (d) Pranab Mukherjee

Answer: (b) PM P.V. Narasimha Rao, FM Manmohan Singh. Reforms – Liberalisation, Privatisation, Globalisation (LPG) after the BoP crisis.

Q27. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] What was the annual growth target of the Tenth Five-Year Plan (2002–07)? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) 5% (b) 6.5%
(c) 8% (d) 9%

Answer: (c) 8% target; actual ≈ 7.6–7.8%. The 10th Plan introduced monitorable targets and state-wise targets.

Q28. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] India's oldest operating oil refinery is at: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Barauni (b) Digboi
(c) Koyali (d) Mathura

Answer: (b) Digboi (Assam), 1901. Jamnagar (Gujarat) is the world's largest refining complex; Mumbai High is the largest offshore field.

Q29. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Prime Meridian (0° longitude) passes through: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Paris (b) Greenwich
(c) Madrid (d) Accra city centre

Answer: (b) Royal Observatory, Greenwich (London), fixed in 1884. 1° longitude = 4 minutes; IST is based on 82°30'E (Mirzapur).

Q30. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The SI unit of magnetic flux is: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Tesla (b) Weber
(c) Gauss (d) Henry

Answer: (b) Weber (Wb = T·m²). Tesla is the unit of magnetic flux density; gauss is its CGS unit; henry is the unit of inductance.

Q31. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The lens formula is: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) $1/f = 1/v + 1/u$ (b) $1/f = 1/v - 1/u$
(c) $f = u + v$ (d) $f = uv$

Answer: (b) Lens: $1/f = 1/v - 1/u$. Mirror: $1/f = 1/v + 1/u$. Power P = 1/f (metre), in dioptre.

Q32. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] In GSLV, the third (upper) stage uses: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Solid propellant (b) Cryogenic propellant
(c) Semi-cryogenic propellant (d) Hybrid propellant

Answer: (b) GSLV's upper stage is cryogenic (liquid hydrogen + liquid oxygen); it places heavier satellites in geosynchronous transfer orbit.

1.4 Static GK

Q33. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Who won the International Booker Prize 2022 for 'Tomb of Sand'? [30 Sep · Prepp Q42]

(a) Arundhati Roy (b) Geetanjali Shree
(c) Kiran Desai (d) Banu Mushtaq

Answer: (b) 'Ret Samadhi' by Geetanjali Shree, translated by Daisy Rockwell – first book translated from an Indian language to win. Banu Mushtaq won in 2025 for 'Heart Lamp' (Kannada).

Q34. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Booker Prize is awarded for: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Peace (b) Fiction written in English
(c) Journalism (d) Science

Answer: (b) The Booker (since 1969, UK) is for a novel written in English; the International Booker is for fiction translated into English.

Q35. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] 'A Suitable Boy' was written by: [1 Oct · Prepp – single source]

(a) Vikram Seth (b) Amitav Ghosh
(c) Salman Rushdie (d) Ruskin Bond

Answer: (a) Vikram Seth (1993), set in 1950s India. His other works: The Golden Gate, An Equal Music.

Q36. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] 'Train to Pakistan' was written by: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Mulk Raj Anand (b) Bhisham Sahni
(c) Khushwant Singh (d) Amrita Pritam

Answer: (c) Khushwant Singh (1956), set in the village of Mano Majra during Partition. Tamas – Bhisham Sahni; Pinjar – Amrita Pritam.

Q37. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] 'Malgudi Days' was written by: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) R.K. Narayan (b) R.K. Laxman
(c) Raja Rao (d) Anita Desai

Answer: (a) R.K. Narayan; Malgudi is a fictional town. His brother R.K. Laxman created 'The Common Man' cartoon.

Q38. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Who was the first Indian to win a Grand Slam title? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Leander Paes (b) Mahesh Bhupathi
(c) Sania Mirza (d) Ramanathan Krishnan

Answer: (b) Mahesh Bhupathi – 1997 French Open mixed doubles with Rika Hiraki.

Q39. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The official length of a marathon is: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) 40 km (b) 42.195 km
(c) 21.0975 km (d) 45 km

Answer: (b) Standardised from the 1908 London Olympics distance. Half marathon = 21.0975 km.

Q40. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The term 'LBW' is used in: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Hockey (b) Football
(c) Cricket (d) Badminton

Answer: (c) Leg Before Wicket. Laws of cricket are maintained by the MCC.

Q41. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Which country hosted the 2022 FIFA World Cup? [30 Sep · Prepp Q45]

(a) Russia (b) Qatar
(c) Brazil (d) UAE

Answer: (b) Qatar – first in the Arab world, played in Nov–Dec. Argentina won; the 2026 edition is in the USA, Canada and Mexico with 48 teams.

Q42. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Manu Bhaker won two bronze medals at the Paris 2024 Olympics in: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Archery (b) Shooting
(c) Wrestling (d) Boxing

Answer: (b) 10 m air pistol (women) and 10 m air pistol mixed team with Sarabjot Singh – first Indian since independence with two medals at one Games.

CHAPTER 2

Part B – Polity Practice MCQs

2.1 Constitution Making, Preamble, Sources

Q43. Who was the President of the Constituent Assembly?

(a) B.R. Ambedkar (b) Rajendra Prasad
(c) Jawaharlal Nehru (d) Sachchidananda Sinha

Answer: (b) Rajendra Prasad was elected permanent President on 11 Dec 1946. Sachchidananda Sinha was the temporary President at the first meeting (9 Dec 1946). Ambedkar chaired the Drafting Committee.

Q44. The Objectives Resolution was moved in the Constituent Assembly by:

(a) Sardar Patel (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) B.N. Rau (d) K.M. Munshi

Answer: (b) Nehru moved it on 13 Dec 1946; adopted 22 Jan 1947. It became the basis of the Preamble.

Q45. The Constitution of India came into force on:

(a) 15 August 1947 (b) 26 November 1949
(c) 26 January 1950 (d) 24 January 1950

Answer: (c) Adopted on 26 Nov 1949 (Constitution Day); enforced on 26 Jan 1950 (Republic Day), the anniversary of the 1930 Purna Swaraj Day.

Q46. Which words were added to the Preamble by the 42nd Amendment?

(a) Sovereign, Democratic (b) Socialist, Secular, Integrity
(c) Republic, Justice (d) Liberty, Equality

Answer: (b) The 42nd Amendment (1976) is the only amendment to the Preamble so far.

Q47. In which case did the Supreme Court hold that the Preamble is a part of the Constitution?

(a) Berubari Union (1960) (b) Golaknath (1967)
(c) Kesavananda Bharati (1973) (d) Minerva Mills (1980)

Answer: (c) Berubari said it was not a part; Kesavananda reversed this and propounded the basic structure doctrine.

Q48. The idea of Directive Principles of State Policy was borrowed from the Constitution of:

(a) USA (b) Ireland
(c) Canada (d) Australia

Answer: (b) Ireland also gave nomination of Rajya Sabha members and the method of electing the President.

Q49. Fundamental Duties were borrowed from the Constitution of:

(a) USA (b) Japan
(c) erstwhile USSR (d) France

Answer: (c) Added by the 42nd Amendment on the Swaran Singh Committee's recommendation.

Q50. The Concurrent List was borrowed from:

(a) Canada (b) Australia
(c) Germany (d) South Africa

Answer: (b) Australia also gave freedom of trade and commerce and the joint sitting of Parliament.

Q51. The procedure for amendment of the Constitution was borrowed from:

(a) USA (b) UK
(c) South Africa (d) Ireland

Answer: (c) South Africa also gave the method of election of Rajya Sabha members.

Q52. Suspension of Fundamental Rights during an emergency was borrowed from:

(a) Weimar Germany (b) USA
(c) Canada (d) Japan

Answer: (a) The Weimar Constitution of Germany.

Q53. Residuary powers vested in the Centre is a feature borrowed from:

(a) USA (b) Canada
(c) Australia (d) Ireland

Answer: (b) Canada – federation with a strong Centre; residuary powers with the Union (Entry 97, Union List; Article 248).

Q54. How many Schedules did the original Constitution have?

(a) 8 (b) 10
(c) 12 (d) 22

Answer: (a) Original: 395 Articles, 22 Parts, 8 Schedules. Now 12 Schedules.

Q55. Which Schedule contains the anti-defection law?

(a) Eighth (b) Ninth
(c) Tenth (d) Eleventh

Answer: (c) Added by the 52nd Amendment (1985). The 91st Amendment (2003) removed the 'split' exception.

Q56. Which Schedule lists the languages recognised by the Constitution?

(a) Seventh (b) Eighth
(c) Ninth (d) Twelfth

Answer: (b) 22 languages now; originally 14.

Q57. The Ninth Schedule was added by:

(a) 1st Amendment, 1951 (b) 7th Amendment, 1956
(c) 42nd Amendment, 1976 (d) 44th Amendment, 1978

Answer: (a) To protect land reform laws from judicial review. I.R. Coelho (2007): laws added after 24 April 1973 can be reviewed on basic structure grounds.

Q58. Which Schedule contains the Union, State and Concurrent Lists?

(a) Fifth (b) Sixth
(c) Seventh (d) Eleventh

Answer: (c) Union List – 100 entries now, State List – 61, Concurrent List – 52.

2.2 Fundamental Rights and Duties

Q59. Article 17 of the Constitution deals with:

(a) Equality of opportunity (b) Abolition of untouchability
(c) Abolition of titles (d) Protection of life

Answer: (b) Untouchability abolished and its practice forbidden; Protection of Civil Rights Act 1955 enforces it.

Q60. The Right to Education (Article 21A) was inserted by:

(a) 42nd Amendment (b) 44th Amendment
(c) 86th Amendment (d) 93rd Amendment

Answer: (c) 86th Amendment (2002) – free and compulsory education for children aged 6–14; also changed Article 45 and added the 11th Fundamental Duty.

Q61. The Right to Property was removed from Fundamental Rights by the:

(a) 42nd Amendment (b) 44th Amendment
(c) 52nd Amendment (d) 61st Amendment

Answer: (b) 44th Amendment (1978); it is now a legal right under Article 300A.

Q62. Which Article prohibits employment of children below 14 in factories and mines?

(a) Article 21A (b) Article 23
(c) Article 24 (d) Article 39

Answer: (c) Article 23 – traffic in human beings and forced labour.

Q63. The writ issued to release a person from illegal detention is:

(a) Mandamus (b) Habeas Corpus
(c) Certiorari (d) Prohibition

Answer: (b) 'To have the body'. It can be issued against both public authorities and private individuals.

Q64. Which writ is issued to an official to perform a public duty?

(a) Quo Warranto (b) Mandamus
(c) Prohibition (d) Certiorari

Answer: (b) 'We command'. It cannot be issued against the President, a Governor or a private person.

Q65. Which writ inquires into the legality of a person's claim to a public office?

(a) Habeas Corpus (b) Certiorari
(c) Quo Warranto (d) Mandamus

Answer: (c) 'By what authority'. Any interested person can seek it.

Q66. Which Fundamental Rights cannot be suspended even during a national emergency?

(a) Articles 14 and 19 (b) Articles 20 and 21
(c) Articles 25 and 26 (d) Articles 29 and 30

Answer: (b) After the 44th Amendment, Articles 20 (protection in respect of conviction) and 21 (life and personal liberty) remain enforceable.

Q67. How many freedoms are guaranteed under Article 19 today?

(a) 5 (b) 6
(c) 7 (d) 8

Answer: (b) Speech & expression, peaceful assembly, associations (incl. co-operatives), movement, residence, profession. The seventh (property) was deleted in 1978.

Q68. The right to privacy was declared a Fundamental Right in:

(a) Maneka Gandhi case (b) K.S. Puttaswamy case
(c) Shayara Bano case (d) Vishaka case

Answer: (b) Puttaswamy (2017), 9-judge bench, under Article 21.

Q69. How many Fundamental Duties are there at present?

(a) 10 (b) 11
(c) 12 (d) 9

Answer: (b) 10 added by the 42nd Amendment (1976) + 1 by the 86th Amendment (2002); Article 51A.

Q70. Which Article guarantees the right of minorities to establish and administer educational institutions?

(a) Article 28 (b) Article 29
(c) Article 30 (d) Article 31

Answer: (c) Article 29 protects language, script and culture of any section of citizens.

2.3 Directive Principles

Q71. The Uniform Civil Code is mentioned in:

(a) Article 39 (b) Article 44
(c) Article 48 (d) Article 51

Answer: (b) Article 44 – DPSP. Goa has a common civil code; Uttarakhand enacted a UCC in 2024.

Q72. Organisation of village panchayats is a directive under:

(a) Article 38 (b) Article 40
(c) Article 43 (d) Article 46

Answer: (b) A Gandhian principle; given constitutional form by the 73rd Amendment.

Q73. Separation of judiciary from executive is directed by:

(a) Article 48A (b) Article 49
(c) Article 50 (d) Article 51

Answer: (c) Article 49 – protection of monuments; Article 51 – international peace.

Q74. Protection and improvement of the environment was added to DPSP as:

(a) Article 47 (b) Article 48A
(c) Article 51A(g) (d) Article 39A

Answer: (b) Inserted by the 42nd Amendment; Article 51A(g) is the corresponding Fundamental Duty.

Q75. Equal justice and free legal aid is provided under:

(a) Article 39A (b) Article 41
(c) Article 42 (d) Article 43A

Answer: (a) Inserted by the 42nd Amendment; implemented through NALSA (Legal Services Authorities Act 1987).

Q76. Promotion of co-operative societies was added as a DPSP by the 97th Amendment as:

(a) Article 43 (b) Article 43A
(c) Article 43B (d) Article 47

Answer: (c) Article 43A – workers' participation in management (42nd Amendment).

2.4 Union Executive and Parliament

Q77. Who administers the oath of office to the President of India?

(a) Vice-President (b) Prime Minister
(c) Chief Justice of India (d) Speaker

Answer: (c) In the CJI's absence, the senior-most Supreme Court judge.

Q78. The President's resignation letter is addressed to the:

(a) Prime Minister (b) Chief Justice of India
(c) Vice-President (d) Speaker

Answer: (c) The Vice-President then informs the Speaker of the Lok Sabha.

Q79. The only ground for impeachment of the President is:

(a) Misbehaviour (b) Incapacity
(c) Violation of the Constitution (d) Corruption

Answer: (c) Article 61; requires a two-thirds majority of the total membership of each House.

Q80. Ordinance-making power of the President is given under:

(a) Article 72 (b) Article 123
(c) Article 213 (d) Article 356

Answer: (b) Article 213 – Governor's ordinance. An ordinance lapses six weeks after Parliament reassembles unless approved.

Q81. Pardoning power of the President is in:

(a) Article 72 (b) Article 74
(c) Article 161 (d) Article 143

Answer: (a) Article 161 – Governor's pardoning power, which does not extend to death sentences.

Q82. Which veto did President Giani Zail Singh use on the Indian Post Office (Amendment) Bill, 1986?

(a) Absolute veto (b) Suspensive veto
(c) Pocket veto (d) Qualified veto

Answer: (c) Pocket veto – no time limit to decide on an ordinary bill.

Q83. The ex-officio Chairman of the Rajya Sabha is the:

(a) President (b) Vice-President
(c) Speaker (d) Prime Minister

Answer: (b) Article 64. He votes only in case of a tie.

Q84. The size of the Council of Ministers is limited to 15% of the Lok Sabha by the:

(a) 42nd Amendment (b) 61st Amendment
(c) 91st Amendment (d) 97th Amendment

Answer: (c) 91st Amendment (2003); in states, 15% of the assembly with a minimum of 12.

Q85. Who decides whether a bill is a money bill?

(a) President (b) Finance Minister
(c) Speaker of Lok Sabha (d) Chairman of Rajya Sabha

Answer: (c) The Speaker's decision is final (Article 110(3)).

Q86. The Rajya Sabha can delay a money bill for a maximum of:

(a) 7 days (b) 14 days
(c) 30 days (d) 6 months

Answer: (b) It can only make recommendations; there is no joint sitting on a money bill.

Q87. A joint sitting of both Houses is presided over by the:

(a) President (b) Vice-President
(c) Speaker (d) Prime Minister

Answer: (c) Article 108. Joint sittings have been held three times – 1961, 1978, 2002.

Q88. Minimum age to be a member of the Rajya Sabha is:

(a) 21 years (b) 25 years
(c) 30 years (d) 35 years

Answer: (c) Lok Sabha 25; President and Vice-President 35.

Q89. How many members can the President nominate to the Rajya Sabha?

(a) 2 (b) 10
(c) 12 (d) 14

Answer: (c) Persons with special knowledge of literature, science, art and social service (Article 80).

Q90. 'Zero Hour' in Parliament is:

(a) Mentioned in the Constitution (b) An Indian innovation not in the rules
(c) Borrowed from the UK (d) The first hour of every sitting

Answer: (b) It starts right after Question Hour and has been used informally since 1962.

Q91. The Public Accounts Committee examines the reports of the:

(a) Finance Commission (b) CAG
(c) UPSC (d) Election Commission

Answer: (b) 22 members (15 LS + 7 RS); its chairman is from the Opposition by convention.

Q92. The quorum for a sitting of either House of Parliament is:

(a) One-fourth of members (b) One-tenth of total members
(c) One-third of members (d) Half of members

Answer: (b) Article 100.

2.5 Judiciary, States, Bodies, Amendments

Q93. The retirement age of a Supreme Court judge is:

(a) 60 years (b) 62 years
(c) 65 years (d) 70 years

Answer: (c) High Court judges retire at 62.

Q94. Advisory jurisdiction of the Supreme Court is under:

(a) Article 131 (b) Article 137
(c) Article 143 (d) Article 145

Answer: (c) The President may seek the Court's opinion; the opinion is not binding.

Q95. The basic structure doctrine was laid down in:

(a) Golaknath case (b) Kesavananda Bharati case
(c) Minerva Mills case (d) Maneka Gandhi case

Answer: (b) 1973, a 13-judge bench, the largest so far.

Q96. Which High Court is the oldest in India?

(a) Bombay (b) Madras
(c) Calcutta (d) Allahabad

Answer: (c) Calcutta HC was established on 1 July 1862; Bombay and Madras followed in August 1862.

Q97. Who appoints the Governor of a state?

(a) Chief Minister (b) President
(c) Prime Minister (d) Chief Justice

Answer: (b) The Governor holds office during the President's pleasure (Article 156).

Q98. In how many states is there a Legislative Council at present?

(a) 4 (b) 5
(c) 6 (d) 7

Answer: (c) Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh.

Q99. Panchayati Raj was first introduced in India at:

(a) Anantapur, Andhra Pradesh (b) Nagaur, Rajasthan
(c) Sabarmati, Gujarat (d) Wardha, Maharashtra

Answer: (b) On 2 October 1959, by Nehru, following the Balwant Rai Mehta Committee.

Q100. How many subjects are in the Eleventh Schedule?

(a) 18 (b) 22
(c) 29 (d) 52

Answer: (c) Twelfth Schedule (Municipalities) has 18 subjects.

Q101. Which Article deals with the Election Commission?

(a) Article 315 (b) Article 324
(c) Article 330 (d) Article 280

Answer: (b) Multi-member since 1993; first CEC Sukumar Sen.

Q102. The Comptroller and Auditor General is appointed under:

(a) Article 76 (b) Article 148
(c) Article 280 (d) Article 315

Answer: (b) Called the 'guardian of the public purse'; term 6 years or age 65.

Q103. The Finance Commission is constituted every:

(a) 2 years (b) 4 years
(c) 5 years (d) 10 years

Answer: (c) Article 280. The 16th Finance Commission is chaired by Arvind Panagariya.

Q104. The GST Council is provided for under:

(a) Article 246A (b) Article 269A
(c) Article 279A (d) Article 280

Answer: (c) Inserted by the 101st Amendment (2016); chaired by the Union Finance Minister.

Q105. The voting age was reduced from 21 to 18 by the:

(a) 42nd Amendment (b) 52nd Amendment
(c) 61st Amendment (d) 73rd Amendment

Answer: (c) 61st Amendment, 1989 (in force 28 March 1989).

Q106. Which amendment is called the 'Mini Constitution'?

(a) 24th (b) 42nd
(c) 44th (d) 73rd

Answer: (b) 42nd (1976) made sweeping changes to the Preamble, FDs, DPSPs, Seventh Schedule, tribunals, etc.

Q107. The 103rd Amendment provides:

(a) Women's reservation
(b) 10% reservation for EWS
(c) National Commission for Backward Classes
(d) GST

Answer: (b) 2019 – Articles 15(6) and 16(6). NCBC – 102nd; women's reservation – 106th.

Q108. The Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam (2023) relates to:

(a) Reservation for women in local bodies
(b) One-third reservation for women in Lok Sabha and state assemblies
(c) Maternity benefits
(d) Women's property rights

Answer: (b) 106th Amendment; to take effect after the next census and delimitation.

Q109. Sikkim became a full-fledged state of India through the:

(a) 35th Amendment
(b) 36th Amendment
(c) 42nd Amendment
(d) 53rd Amendment

Answer: (b) 36th Amendment, 1975. The 35th had made it an 'associate state'.

Q110. Which Article contains the procedure for amending the Constitution?

(a) Article 352
(b) Article 360
(c) Article 368
(d) Article 370

Answer: (c) Special majority, with ratification by half the states for federal provisions.

Q111. President's Rule in a state is imposed under:

(a) Article 352
(b) Article 356
(c) Article 360
(d) Article 365

Answer: (b) Approval within 2 months; maximum 3 years; first imposed in Punjab (1951).

Q112. The National Emergency has been proclaimed how many times?

(a) Once
(b) Twice
(c) Thrice
(d) Never

Answer: (c) 1962 (China), 1971 (Pakistan), 1975 (internal disturbance).

Q113. The Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam replaced:

(a) Indian Penal Code
(b) Indian Evidence Act
(c) Code of Civil Procedure
(d) Code of Criminal Procedure

Answer: (b) In force from 1 July 2024; electronic records treated as primary evidence.

Q114. NITI Aayog came into existence on:

(a) 15 March 1950
(b) 1 January 2015
(c) 26 January 2015
(d) 15 August 2014

Answer: (b) Replaced the Planning Commission; chaired by the Prime Minister; created by an executive resolution (non-constitutional).

CHAPTER 3

Part B – History Practice MCQs

3.1 Ancient India

Q115. The Great Bath was found at:

(a) Harappa (b) Mohenjo-daro
(c) Lothal (d) Kalibangan

Answer: (b) Mohenjo-daro (Sindh). Lothal had the dockyard; Kalibangan the ploughed field.

Q116. Which Harappan site is famous for its dockyard?

(a) Dholavira (b) Lothal
(c) Banawali (d) Ropar

Answer: (b) Lothal (Gujarat), on the Bhogavo river; also a bead-making centre.

Q117. The largest Harappan site in India is:

(a) Dholavira (b) Kalibangan
(c) Rakhigarhi (d) Lothal

Answer: (c) Rakhigarhi (Haryana). Dholavira (Gujarat) became a UNESCO site in 2021.

Q118. The Gayatri Mantra is found in which Veda?

(a) Samaveda (b) Yajurveda
(c) Rigveda (d) Atharvaveda

Answer: (c) Rigveda, Mandala III, addressed to Savitri.

Q119. 'Satyameva Jayate' is taken from the:

(a) Katha Upanishad (b) Mundaka Upanishad
(c) Rigveda (d) Bhagavad Gita

Answer: (b) It appears below the National Emblem.

Q120. Which Veda is regarded as the source of Indian music?

(a) Rigveda (b) Samaveda
(c) Yajurveda (d) Atharvaveda

Answer: (b) Samaveda – melodies (saman) for chanting.

Q121. The only Mahajanapada located in South India was:

(a) Avanti (b) Assaka
(c) Chedi (d) Vatsa

Answer: (b) Assaka (Ashmaka) on the Godavari; capital Potali/Paithan.

Q122. Pataliputra was founded by:

(a) Bimbisara (b) Ajatashatru
(c) Udayin (d) Mahapadma Nanda

Answer: (c) Udayin (Haryanka dynasty) shifted the capital from Rajagriha to Pataliputra.

Q123. Buddha delivered his first sermon at:

(a) Bodh Gaya (b) Lumbini
(c) Sarnath (d) Kushinagar

Answer: (c) Sarnath (Deer Park) – Dharmachakra Pravartana.

Q124. The Fourth Buddhist Council was held under the patronage of:

(a) Ashoka (b) Kanishka
(c) Ajatashatru (d) Kalashoka

Answer: (b) In Kashmir (Kundalvana); Buddhism split into Hinayana and Mahayana.

Q125. Who was the 23rd Tirthankara of Jainism?

(a) Rishabhanatha (b) Parshvanatha
(c) Mahavira (d) Neminatha

Answer: (b) Parshvanatha gave four vows; Mahavira (24th) added Brahmacharya.

Q126. Who deciphered the Brahmi script of Ashokan edicts?

(a) Alexander Cunningham (b) James Prinsep
(c) William Jones (d) John Marshall

Answer: (b) James Prinsep, 1837.

Q127. The Kalinga War is described in Ashoka's:

(a) Minor Rock Edict I (b) Major Rock Edict XIII
(c) Pillar Edict VII (d) Rummindei inscription

Answer: (b) Major Rock Edict XIII records the suffering and Ashoka's remorse.

Q128. 'Indica' was written by:

(a) Kautilya (b) Megasthenes
(c) Fa-Hien (d) Pliny

Answer: (b) Megasthenes, ambassador of Seleucus Nikator to Chandragupta Maurya.

Q129. Who is known as the 'Napoleon of India'?

(a) Chandragupta II (b) Samudragupta
(c) Ashoka (d) Harsha

Answer: (b) Called so by V.A. Smith; his conquests are recorded in the Prayag Prashasti by Harisena.

Q130. Nalanda University was founded by:

(a) Harsha (b) Kumaragupta I
(c) Dharmapala (d) Chandragupta II

Answer: (b) Kumaragupta I (Gupta), 5th century CE. Vikramashila was founded by Dharmapala (Pala).

Q131. Which Chinese traveller visited India during Harsha's reign?

(a) Fa-Hien (b) Hiuen Tsang
(c) I-Tsing (d) Sung Yun

Answer: (b) Hiuen Tsang (Xuanzang), 'prince of pilgrims'. Fa-Hien came under Chandragupta II.

Q132. Who wrote 'Harshacharita'?

(a) Kalidasa (b) Banabhatta
(c) Bhavabhuti (d) Dandin

Answer: (b) Banabhatta, court poet of Harsha; also wrote Kadambari.

Q133. The Shaka era, used as India's national calendar, began in:

(a) 57 BCE (b) 78 CE
(c) 320 CE (d) 606 CE

Answer: (b) Associated with Kanishka. Vikram Samvat began in 57 BCE; Gupta era in 319–320 CE.

Q134. Who wrote the 'Aryabhatiya'?

(a) Varahamihira (b) Brahmagupta
(c) Aryabhata (d) Bhaskara

Answer: (c) Aryabhata (Gupta age) – rotation of the earth, value of π.

Q135. The Kailasa temple at Ellora was built by:

(a) Pallavas (b) Rashtrakutas
(c) Chalukyas (d) Cholas

Answer: (b) Krishna I (Rashtrakuta), 8th century; monolithic rock-cut temple (Cave 16).

Q136. Brihadeshwara temple at Thanjavur was built by:

(a) Rajendra I (b) Rajaraja I
(c) Vijayalaya (d) Karikala

Answer: (b) Rajaraja Chola I, completed c. 1010 CE; part of the Great Living Chola Temples (UNESCO).

Q137. The Uttaramerur inscriptions give information about:

(a) Chola local self-government (b) Gupta coinage
(c) Pallava art (d) Mauryan army

Answer: (a) Village assemblies (Ur, Sabha) and elections by lot under the Cholas.

Q138. Who compiled the Rajatarangini, a history of Kashmir?

(a) Bilhana (b) Kalhana
(c) Jayadeva (d) Somadeva

Answer: (b) Kalhana, 12th century – India's first historical chronicle.

3.2 Medieval India

Q139. The Second Battle of Tarain (1192) was fought between Muhammad Ghori and:

(a) Jaichand (b) Prithviraj Chauhan
(c) Bhimdev II (d) Rana Sanga

Answer: (b) Ghori won, laying the foundation of Turkish rule. Prithviraj had won the First Battle (1191).

Q140. Who completed the construction of the Qutub Minar?

(a) Qutbuddin Aibak (b) Iltutmish
(c) Alauddin Khilji (d) Balban

Answer: (b) Aibak began it; Iltutmish completed it; Firoz Shah Tughlaq repaired it.

Q141. The silver 'tanka' and copper 'jital' were introduced by:

(a) Balban (b) Iltutmish
(c) Alauddin Khilji (d) Muhammad bin Tughlaq

Answer: (b) Iltutmish – the real consolidator of the Delhi Sultanate.

Q142. Who introduced the market control system in the Delhi Sultanate?

(a) Balban (b) Alauddin Khilji
(c) Firoz Shah Tughlaq (d) Sikandar Lodi

Answer: (b) Alauddin also introduced Dagh (branding of horses) and Chehra (descriptive rolls of soldiers).

Q143. Who transferred the capital from Delhi to Daulatabad?

(a) Alauddin Khilji (b) Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq
(c) Muhammad bin Tughlaq (d) Firoz Shah Tughlaq

Answer: (c) In 1327. He also introduced token currency.

Q144. The city of Agra was founded by:

(a) Akbar (b) Babur
(c) Sikandar Lodi (d) Sher Shah

Answer: (c) Sikandar Lodi, 1504.

Q145. Who was the first woman ruler of the Delhi Sultanate?

(a) Nur Jahan (b) Razia Sultan
(c) Chand Bibi (d) Rani Durgavati

Answer: (b) Razia Sultan (1236–40), daughter of Iltutmish.

Q146. The Vijayanagara Empire was founded in 1336 by:

(a) Krishnadeva Raya (b) Harihara and Bukka
(c) Deva Raya I (d) Rama Raya

Answer: (b) With guidance from Vidyaranya; capital Hampi.

Q147. 'Amuktamalyada' was written by:

(a) Tenali Rama (b) Krishnadeva Raya
(c) Allasani Peddana (d) Vidyaranya

Answer: (b) A Telugu work by the Vijayanagara king Krishnadeva Raya.

Q148. The Battle of Talikota was fought in:

(a) 1526 (b) 1556
(c) 1565 (d) 1576

Answer: (c) Deccan Sultanates defeated Vijayanagara (Rama Raya).

Q149. Gol Gumbaz is located in:

(a) Golconda (b) Bijapur
(c) Bidar (d) Gulbarga

Answer: (b) Tomb of Muhammad Adil Shah; famous whispering gallery.

Q150. The First Battle of Panipat (1526) was fought between Babur and:

(a) Rana Sanga (b) Ibrahim Lodi
(c) Hemu (d) Sher Shah

Answer: (b) Babur's victory founded the Mughal Empire; first use of field artillery in India.

Q151. The Second Battle of Panipat (1556) was fought between Akbar and:

(a) Hemu (b) Ibrahim Lodi
(c) Sher Shah (d) Ahmad Shah Abdali

Answer: (a) Bairam Khan led Akbar's forces.

Q152. The Third Battle of Panipat (1761) was won by:

(a) Marathas (b) Ahmad Shah Abdali
(c) Mughals (d) East India Company

Answer: (b) Abdali defeated the Marathas led by Sadashiv Rao Bhau.

Q153. The Battle of Haldighati (1576) was fought between Akbar's forces and:

(a) Rana Sanga (b) Maharana Pratap
(c) Rana Kumbha (d) Udai Singh

Answer: (b) The Mughal army was led by Raja Man Singh.

Q154. Who introduced the silver coin 'Rupiya'?

(a) Akbar (b) Sher Shah Suri
(c) Muhammad bin Tughlaq (d) Alauddin Khilji

Answer: (b) Sher Shah also built/rebuilt the Grand Trunk Road (Sadak-e-Azam).

Q155. Akbar's Din-i-Ilahi was promulgated in:

(a) 1556 (b) 1575
(c) 1582 (d) 1605

Answer: (c) Ibadat Khana at Fatehpur Sikri was built in 1575.

Q156. 'Humayunnama' was written by:

(a) Abul Fazl (b) Gulbadan Begum
(c) Jahangir (d) Badauni

Answer: (b) Humayun's half-sister.

Q157. Bibi ka Maqbara at Aurangabad was built by:

(a) Aurangzeb (b) Azam Shah
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Bahadur Shah I

Answer: (b) Azam Shah, for his mother Dilras Banu Begum; called the 'Taj of the Deccan'.

Q158. The Khalsa was founded in 1699 by:

(a) Guru Nanak (b) Guru Arjan Dev
(c) Guru Tegh Bahadur (d) Guru Gobind Singh

Answer: (d) At Anandpur Sahib on Baisakhi.

Q159. The Adi Granth was compiled by:

(a) Guru Angad (b) Guru Ram Das
(c) Guru Arjan Dev (d) Guru Hargobind

Answer: (c) 1604; he also built the Harmandir Sahib.

Q160. Shivaji's council of eight ministers was called:

(a) Ashtadiggaja (b) Ashtapradhan
(c) Navaratna (d) Panch Pradhan

Answer: (b) Peshwa was the Prime Minister. Ashtadiggajas were Krishnadeva Raya's eight poets.

3.3 Modern India

Q161. Vasco da Gama reached Calicut in:

(a) 1492 (b) 1498
(c) 1510 (d) 1600

Answer: (b) Received by the Zamorin; the Portuguese were the first Europeans to come and the last to leave (Goa, 1961).

Q162. The Battle of Plassey (1757) was fought between the British and:

(a) Mir Qasim (b) Siraj-ud-Daulah
(c) Shuja-ud-Daulah (d) Tipu Sultan

Answer: (b) Robert Clive won with Mir Jafar's treachery.

Q163. The Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa was granted to the East India Company by the Treaty of:

(a) Allahabad (1765) (b) Salbai (1782)
(c) Bassein (1802) (d) Srirangapatna (1792)

Answer: (a) After the Battle of Buxar (1764).

Q164. The Subsidiary Alliance was introduced by:

(a) Lord Cornwallis (b) Lord Wellesley
(c) Lord Dalhousie (d) Lord Hastings

Answer: (b) 1798; Hyderabad was the first to accept it.

Q165. The Doctrine of Lapse is associated with:

(a) Lord Dalhousie (b) Lord Canning
(c) Lord Curzon (d) Lord Wellesley

Answer: (a) Satara (1848) was the first state annexed under it.

Q166. The Permanent Settlement of 1793 was introduced by:

(a) Warren Hastings (b) Lord Cornwallis
(c) Thomas Munro (d) William Bentinck

Answer: (b) In Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, with zamindars.

Q167. The first railway line in India ran between:

(a) Calcutta and Howrah (b) Bombay and Thane
(c) Madras and Arcot (d) Delhi and Agra

Answer: (b) 16 April 1853, under Lord Dalhousie.

Q168. The Revolt of 1857 began at:

(a) Barrackpore (b) Meerut
(c) Delhi (d) Kanpur

Answer: (b) 10 May 1857. Mangal Pandey's act at Barrackpore was in March 1857.

Q169. Who led the Revolt of 1857 at Lucknow?

(a) Rani Lakshmibai (b) Begum Hazrat Mahal
(c) Nana Saheb (d) Kunwar Singh

Answer: (b) Kunwar Singh led in Bihar (Jagdishpur); Nana Saheb at Kanpur.

Q170. Who is called the 'Father of Local Self-Government in India'?

(a) Lord Mayo (b) Lord Ripon
(c) Lord Curzon (d) Lord Lytton

Answer: (b) Resolution of 1882.

Q171. The Partition of Bengal (1905) was carried out by:

(a) Lord Minto (b) Lord Curzon
(c) Lord Hardinge (d) Lord Lansdowne

Answer: (b) Annulled in 1911 under Lord Hardinge II.

Q172. The Arya Samaj was founded by:

(a) Raja Ram Mohan Roy (b) Swami Dayanand Saraswati
(c) Swami Vivekananda (d) Keshab Chandra Sen

Answer: (b) 1875, Bombay; 'Go back to the Vedas'; Satyarth Prakash.

Q173. The first President of the Indian National Congress was:

(a) A.O. Hume (b) W.C. Bonnerjee
(c) Dadabhai Naoroji (d) Surendranath Banerjee

Answer: (b) Bombay, 28 December 1885.

Q174. The 'Purna Swaraj' resolution was passed at the INC session of:

(a) Calcutta 1928 (b) Lahore 1929
(c) Karachi 1931 (d) Lucknow 1916

Answer: (b) President Jawaharlal Nehru; 26 January 1930 was celebrated as Independence Day.

Q175. Gandhi's first satyagraha in India was at:

(a) Kheda (b) Champaran
(c) Ahmedabad (d) Bardoli

Answer: (b) Champaran (Bihar), 1917 – indigo farmers.

Q176. The Jallianwala Bagh massacre took place on:

(a) 13 April 1919 (b) 6 April 1919
(c) 30 January 1919 (d) 13 April 1920

Answer: (a) Ordered by General Dyer at Amritsar; Tagore returned his knighthood.

Q177. The Non-Cooperation Movement was withdrawn after the incident at:

(a) Chauri Chaura (b) Bardoli
(c) Dandi (d) Champaran

Answer: (a) February 1922, Gorakhpur district.

Q178. The Dandi March began on:

(a) 26 January 1930 (b) 12 March 1930
(c) 6 April 1930 (d) 8 August 1942

Answer: (b) From Sabarmati Ashram; salt law broken at Dandi on 6 April 1930.

Q179. The 'Do or Die' slogan was given during the:

(a) Non-Cooperation Movement (b) Civil Disobedience Movement
(c) Quit India Movement (d) Khilafat Movement

Answer: (c) 8 August 1942, Gowalia Tank, Bombay.

Q180. Which Round Table Conference did Gandhi attend?

(a) First (b) Second
(c) Third (d) All three

Answer: (b) Second RTC, London, 1931, after the Gandhi–Irwin Pact.

CHAPTER 4

Part B – Art & Culture Practice MCQs

4.1 Dances

Q181. Sattriya, a classical dance, belongs to:

(a) Manipur (b) Assam
(c) Odisha (d) Kerala

Answer: (b) Introduced by Shankardev in the sattras; recognised as classical in 2000.

Q182. Kuchipudi originated in:

(a) Tamil Nadu (b) Karnataka
(c) Andhra Pradesh (d) Kerala

Answer: (c) Named after a village in Krishna district; Tarangam is danced on a brass plate.

Q183. Which two classical dances belong to Kerala?

(a) Kathakali and Mohiniyattam (b) Kathakali and Kuchipudi
(c) Odissi and Mohiniyattam (d) Bharatanatyam and Kathakali

Answer: (a) Kathakali – dance-drama; Mohiniyattam – solo female lasya.

Q184. The 'tribhanga' posture is characteristic of:

(a) Kathak (b) Odissi
(c) Manipuri (d) Bharatanatyam

Answer: (b) Three bends of the body – head, torso, knees.

Q185. Birju Maharaj was an exponent of:

(a) Kathak (b) Kathakali
(c) Odissi (d) Bharatanatyam

Answer: (a) Lucknow gharana.

Q186. Kelucharan Mohapatra is associated with:

(a) Kuchipudi (b) Odissi
(c) Manipuri (d) Sattriya

Answer: (b) He revived Odissi in the 20th century.

Q187. Lavani is a folk dance of:

(a) Gujarat (b) Maharashtra
(c) Rajasthan (d) Goa

Answer: (b) Performed to the beat of the dholki; Tamasha is the related folk theatre.

Q188. Yakshagana is associated with:

(a) Kerala (b) Karnataka
(c) Tamil Nadu (d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: (b) Dance-drama of coastal Karnataka.

Q189. Garba and Dandiya Raas are folk dances of:

(a) Rajasthan (b) Gujarat
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Haryana

Answer: (b) Performed during Navratri; Garba was added to UNESCO's ICH list in 2023.

Q190. Hojagiri is a folk dance of:

(a) Tripura (b) Manipur
(c) Nagaland (d) Sikkim

Answer: (a) Performed by the Reang (Bru) community, balancing on pitchers.

Q191. Ghoomar is a folk dance of:

(a) Punjab (b) Rajasthan
(c) Haryana (d) Himachal Pradesh

Answer: (b) Originated with the Bhil tribe; Kalbelia (Rajasthan) is on UNESCO's ICH list.

Q192. Theyyam is a ritual dance of:

(a) Karnataka (b) Kerala
(c) Goa (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (b) North Kerala (Kannur, Kasaragod).

Q193. Nati, which holds a Guinness record, is a dance of:

(a) Uttarakhand (b) Himachal Pradesh
(c) Jammu & Kashmir (d) Sikkim

Answer: (b) Kullu Nati.

Q194. Raut Nacha and Panthi are dances of:

(a) Odisha (b) Chhattisgarh
(c) Jharkhand (d) Madhya Pradesh

Answer: (b) Panthi – Satnami community.

Q195. Which form of Chhau is performed without masks?

(a) Purulia (b) Seraikela
(c) Mayurbhanj (d) All use masks

Answer: (c) Mayurbhanj (Odisha). Purulia (West Bengal) and Seraikela (Jharkhand) use masks.

4.2 Festivals and Music

Q196. The Hornbill Festival is celebrated in:

(a) Mizoram (b) Nagaland
(c) Manipur (d) Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: (b) 1–10 December at Kisama heritage village near Kohima.

Q197. Wangala is the harvest festival of the Garo tribe of:

(a) Assam (b) Meghalaya
(c) Tripura (d) Nagaland

Answer: (b) Known as the '100 drums festival'.

Q198. Sangai Festival is held in:

(a) Manipur (b) Mizoram
(c) Sikkim (d) Assam

Answer: (a) Named after the brow-antlered deer, Manipur's state animal.

Q199. Losar is the New Year festival celebrated mainly in:

(a) Kerala (b) Ladakh, Sikkim and Arunachal
(c) Punjab (d) Gujarat

Answer: (b) Tibetan Buddhist New Year.

Q200. Onam is associated with the legend of:

(a) King Bali (Mahabali) (b) Lord Rama
(c) Lord Krishna (d) Goddess Durga

Answer: (a) Harvest festival of Kerala; Vallam Kali boat races.

Q201. Nuakhai is a festival of:

(a) Bihar (b) Odisha
(c) Jharkhand (d) West Bengal

Answer: (b) Western Odisha – eating the new rice.

Q202. Kharchi Puja is celebrated in:

(a) Tripura (b) Sikkim
(c) Assam (d) Meghalaya

Answer: (a) Worship of the 14 deities, Agartala.

Q203. Bastar Dussehra, lasting about 75 days, is celebrated in:

(a) Odisha (b) Chhattisgarh
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Telangana

Answer: (b) Dedicated to the goddess Danteshwari.

Q204. The Carnatic music 'trinity' does NOT include:

(a) Tyagaraja (b) Muthuswami Dikshitar
(c) Syama Sastri (d) Purandaradasa

Answer: (d) Purandaradasa is called the 'father of Carnatic music'; he is not part of the trinity.

Q205. Amjad Ali Khan is associated with:

(a) Sitar (b) Sarod
(c) Santoor (d) Sarangi

Answer: (b) Son of Haafiz Ali Khan; Senia Bangash gharana.

Q206. Shivkumar Sharma was a maestro of:

(a) Santoor (b) Tabla
(c) Flute (d) Shehnai

Answer: (a) He made the Kashmiri santoor a classical instrument.

Q207. Zakir Hussain was a famous:

(a) Sitar player (b) Tabla player
(c) Sarod player (d) Vocalist

Answer: (b) Son of Ustad Alla Rakha; multiple Grammy winner.

Q208. Ram Narayan was known for playing the:

(a) Sarangi (b) Violin
(c) Veena (d) Mridangam

Answer: (a) He established the sarangi as a solo concert instrument.

Q209. Who was the first musician to receive the Bharat Ratna?

(a) Ravi Shankar (b) M.S. Subbulakshmi
(c) Lata Mangeshkar (d) Bismillah Khan

Answer: (b) M.S. Subbulakshmi, 1998.

Q210. Which instrument is an 'avanaddha vadya' (membranophone)?

(a) Veena (b) Flute
(c) Tabla (d) Ghatam

Answer: (c) Tata – strings; sushira – wind; avanaddha – membrane; ghana – solid (ghatam, cymbals).

4.3 Monuments, Paintings, Heritage

Q211. Konark Sun Temple was built by:

(a) Narasimhadeva I (b) Anantavarman Chodaganga
(c) Rajaraja I (d) Kharavela

Answer: (a) Eastern Ganga dynasty, 13th century; called the 'Black Pagoda'.

Q212. Which was the first garden tomb in India?

(a) Taj Mahal (b) Humayun's Tomb
(c) Akbar's Tomb (d) Safdarjung's Tomb

Answer: (b) Built by Hamida Banu Begum; architect Mirak Mirza Ghiyas.

Q213. Rani ki Vav, a stepwell featured on the ₹100 note, is in:

(a) Rajasthan (b) Gujarat
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Maharashtra

Answer: (b) Patan, Gujarat; UNESCO site (2014).

Q214. The Jantar Mantar observatories were built by:

(a) Sawai Jai Singh II (b) Maharaja Ranjit Singh
(c) Akbar (d) Raja Man Singh

Answer: (a) At Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain, Varanasi and Mathura.

Q215. The first Indian city declared a UNESCO World Heritage City is:

(a) Jaipur (b) Ahmedabad
(c) Varanasi (d) Hyderabad

Answer: (b) 2017. Jaipur followed in 2019.

Q216. Madhubani painting belongs to:

(a) Bihar (b) Odisha
(c) West Bengal (d) Uttar Pradesh

Answer: (a) Mithila region.

Q217. Warli painting is a tribal art form of:

(a) Gujarat (b) Maharashtra
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Chhattisgarh

Answer: (b) White pigment on a mud base.

Q218. Kalamkari painting is associated with:

(a) Tamil Nadu (b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Kerala (d) Karnataka

Answer: (b) Srikalahasti and Machilipatnam styles.

Q219. Phad painting, scroll paintings of folk deities, is from:

(a) Rajasthan (b) Gujarat
(c) Punjab (d) Uttar Pradesh

Answer: (a) Narratives of Pabuji and Devnarayan.

Q220. Kathputli puppetry is associated with:

(a) Rajasthan (b) Odisha
(c) Karnataka (d) Kerala

Answer: (a) String puppetry.

Q221. Which was the first product to receive a GI tag in India?

(a) Basmati rice (b) Darjeeling tea
(c) Mysore silk (d) Alphonso mango

Answer: (b) 2004–05.

Q222. How many languages are in the Eighth Schedule?

(a) 18 (b) 21
(c) 22 (d) 24

Answer: (c) The 92nd Amendment (2003) added Bodo, Dogri, Maithili and Santhali.

Q223. The first language declared 'classical' in India was:

(a) Sanskrit (b) Tamil
(c) Telugu (d) Kannada

Answer: (b) Tamil, 2004. Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese and Bengali were added in 2024 (11 in total).

Q224. Ol Chiki is the script of:

(a) Bodo (b) Santhali
(c) Manipuri (d) Dogri

Answer: (b) Devised by Raghunath Murmu.

Q225. The Natyashastra was written by:

(a) Kalidasa (b) Bharat Muni
(c) Bhasa (d) Vatsyayana

Answer: (b) Source text of Indian drama, dance and music.

CHAPTER 5

Part B – Economy Practice MCQs

5.1 Basic Concepts and National Income

Q226. Who is known as the 'Father of Economics'?

(a) J.M. Keynes (b) Adam Smith
(c) Alfred Marshall (d) David Ricardo

Answer: (b) 'The Wealth of Nations' (1776). Keynes is the father of modern macroeconomics.

Q227. A market with a single buyer is called:

(a) Monopoly (b) Monopsony
(c) Oligopoly (d) Duopoly

Answer: (b) Monopoly – one seller; oligopoly – few sellers; duopoly – two sellers.

Q228. Goods whose demand rises when their price rises because they are inferior staples are:

(a) Veblen goods (b) Giffen goods
(c) Normal goods (d) Complementary goods

Answer: (b) Veblen goods are luxury/prestige goods – another exception to the law of demand.

Q229. GNP is equal to:

(a) GDP − depreciation (b) GDP + net factor income from abroad
(c) NNP + indirect taxes (d) GDP − subsidies

Answer: (b) 'National' includes income of nationals abroad; 'Domestic' covers production within borders.

Q230. National Income in India is measured as:

(a) GDP at market price (b) NNP at factor cost
(c) GNP at market price (d) NDP at market price

Answer: (b) NNP at factor cost = NNP at market price − net indirect taxes.

Q231. Who made the first estimate of India's national income?

(a) V.K.R.V. Rao (b) Dadabhai Naoroji
(c) P.C. Mahalanobis (d) R.C. Dutt

Answer: (b) In 1867–68 (Poverty and Un-British Rule in India). V.K.R.V. Rao made the first scientific estimate (1931).

Q232. The current base year for India's GDP series is:

(a) 2004–05 (b) 2011–12
(c) 2015–16 (d) 2017–18

Answer: (b) A revision of the base year has been planned by MoSPI.

Q233. The Human Development Index is published by:

(a) World Bank (b) IMF
(c) UNDP (d) WTO

Answer: (c) Since 1990; developed by Mahbub ul Haq with Amartya Sen. Indicators: life expectancy, education, GNI per capita.

Q234. A situation of high inflation together with stagnant growth is called:

(a) Deflation (b) Stagflation
(c) Disinflation (d) Reflation

Answer: (b) Disinflation = falling rate of inflation; deflation = falling price level.

Q235. The Consumer Price Index (CPI) in India is compiled by:

(a) RBI (b) National Statistics Office
(c) NITI Aayog (d) Finance Ministry

Answer: (b) WPI is compiled by the Office of the Economic Adviser (DPIIT).

Q236. RBI's inflation target under flexible inflation targeting is:

(a) 2% ± 1% (b) 4% ± 2%
(c) 5% ± 1% (d) 6% ± 2%

Answer: (b) Measured on CPI (combined); set by the government in consultation with RBI.

5.2 Planning and Reforms

Q237. The Planning Commission was set up on:

(a) 15 August 1947 (b) 26 January 1950
(c) 15 March 1950 (d) 1 April 1951

Answer: (c) By an executive resolution, with the PM as chairman. Replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015.

Q238. The Second Five-Year Plan was based on the model of:

(a) Harrod–Domar (b) P.C. Mahalanobis
(c) Gadgil (d) Rao–Manmohan

Answer: (b) Focus on heavy industry; steel plants at Bhilai, Durgapur, Rourkela.

Q239. The First Five-Year Plan gave top priority to:

(a) Heavy industry (b) Agriculture and irrigation
(c) Poverty removal (d) Employment

Answer: (b) Based on the Harrod–Domar model; exceeded its target.

Q240. The period of 'Plan Holiday' was:

(a) 1961–64 (b) 1966–69
(c) 1978–80 (d) 1990–92

Answer: (b) Three annual plans after the failure of the Third Plan.

Q241. 'Garibi Hatao' was the slogan of the:

(a) Fourth Plan (b) Fifth Plan
(c) Sixth Plan (d) Seventh Plan

Answer: (b) Fifth Plan (1974–78), terminated early by the Janata government.

Q242. The 'Rolling Plan' concept was introduced by the:

(a) Congress government (1969) (b) Janata government (1978)
(c) NDA government (1999) (d) UPA government (2004)

Answer: (b) 1978–80; concept from Gunnar Myrdal.

Q243. The last Five-Year Plan was the:

(a) Tenth (b) Eleventh
(c) Twelfth (d) Thirteenth

Answer: (c) 2012–17: 'faster, more inclusive and sustainable growth'.

Q244. The 1991 economic reforms are summed up as:

(a) PPP (b) LPG
(c) MSP (d) FDI

Answer: (b) Liberalisation, Privatisation, Globalisation.

Q245. FERA was replaced by FEMA in:

(a) 1991 (b) 1995
(c) 1999 (d) 2002

Answer: (c) Foreign Exchange Management Act, 1999 – civil rather than criminal law.

Q246. The MRTP Act was replaced by the:

(a) Competition Act, 2002 (b) FEMA, 1999
(c) Companies Act, 2013 (d) IBC, 2016

Answer: (a) Competition Commission of India enforces it.

Q247. The Narasimham Committee (1991) was related to reforms in:

(a) Taxation (b) Banking
(c) Insurance (d) Agriculture

Answer: (b) Raja Chelliah – tax reforms; Malhotra – insurance reforms.

5.3 Banking and Money

Q248. The Reserve Bank of India was established on:

(a) 1 January 1949 (b) 1 April 1935
(c) 15 August 1947 (d) 1 July 1955

Answer: (b) Nationalised on 1 January 1949; HQ Mumbai.

Q249. Who issues the one-rupee note in India?

(a) RBI (b) Ministry of Finance
(c) SBI (d) Security Printing Press

Answer: (b) It bears the signature of the Finance Secretary; RBI issues all other notes.

Q250. The rate at which RBI lends short-term funds to commercial banks is the:

(a) Bank rate (b) Repo rate
(c) Reverse repo rate (d) CRR

Answer: (b) Reverse repo – rate at which RBI borrows from banks; bank rate – long-term lending.

Q251. The portion of deposits that banks must keep with the RBI is the:

(a) SLR (b) CRR
(c) Repo (d) MSF

Answer: (b) SLR is kept by banks themselves in cash, gold or approved securities.

Q252. To control inflation, the RBI would generally:

(a) Reduce repo rate (b) Increase repo rate
(c) Reduce CRR (d) Buy government securities

Answer: (b) Dear-money policy reduces liquidity. Buying securities injects money.

Q253. The Monetary Policy Committee has how many members?

(a) 4 (b) 5
(c) 6 (d) 7

Answer: (c) 3 from RBI (including the Governor, who has a casting vote) and 3 government nominees.

Q254. Which is known as 'broad money'?

(a) M1 (b) M2
(c) M3 (d) M4

Answer: (c) M3 = M1 + time deposits with banks; M1 is narrow money.

Q255. Fourteen major banks were nationalised on:

(a) 19 July 1969 (b) 15 April 1980
(c) 1 July 1955 (d) 26 January 1969

Answer: (a) Six more on 15 April 1980.

Q256. State Bank of India was formed on 1 July 1955 from the:

(a) Bank of Hindostan (b) Imperial Bank of India
(c) Allahabad Bank (d) Punjab National Bank

Answer: (b) Imperial Bank (1921) itself merged the three Presidency banks.

Q257. NABARD was established in:

(a) 1969 (b) 1975
(c) 1982 (d) 1990

Answer: (c) 12 July 1982, on the recommendation of the B. Sivaraman Committee; apex bank for agriculture and rural development.

Q258. Regional Rural Banks were set up in:

(a) 1969 (b) 1975
(c) 1982 (d) 1991

Answer: (b) 2 October 1975 (Narasimham Working Group).

Q259. Which body regulates the securities market in India?

(a) RBI (b) SEBI
(c) IRDAI (d) PFRDA

Answer: (b) SEBI – est. 1988, statutory powers 1992; HQ Mumbai.

Q260. The SENSEX consists of how many companies?

(a) 30 (b) 50
(c) 100 (d) 500

Answer: (a) BSE (1875, Asia's oldest exchange). NIFTY 50 is on the NSE.

Q261. UPI is operated by:

(a) RBI (b) NPCI
(c) SBI (d) NABARD

Answer: (b) National Payments Corporation of India (2008); UPI launched in 2016.

5.4 Budget, Taxes and Trade

Q262. Fiscal deficit minus interest payments equals:

(a) Revenue deficit (b) Primary deficit
(c) Effective revenue deficit (d) Budget deficit

Answer: (b) Primary deficit shows borrowing for current needs excluding past interest.

Q263. Which of these is a capital receipt?

(a) Income tax (b) Dividends from PSUs
(c) Disinvestment proceeds (d) Fees and fines

Answer: (c) Capital receipts: borrowings, recovery of loans, disinvestment. Others are revenue receipts.

Q264. The Union Budget is called the 'Annual Financial Statement' in:

(a) Article 110 (b) Article 112
(c) Article 114 (d) Article 266

Answer: (b) Article 114 – Appropriation Bill; Article 266 – Consolidated Fund.

Q265. Which is an example of a direct tax?

(a) GST (b) Customs duty
(c) Income tax (d) Excise duty

Answer: (c) Direct tax burden cannot be shifted. GST is indirect.

Q266. GST was introduced in India on:

(a) 1 April 2017 (b) 1 July 2017
(c) 15 August 2017 (d) 1 January 2018

Answer: (b) 101st Amendment (2016); 'One Nation, One Tax'.

Q267. Which state was the first to ratify the GST Constitutional Amendment Bill?

(a) Bihar (b) Assam
(c) Gujarat (d) Jharkhand

Answer: (b) Assam, August 2016.

Q268. The FRBM Act was enacted in:

(a) 1991 (b) 2000
(c) 2003 (d) 2008

Answer: (c) Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management – to cut fiscal and revenue deficits.

Q269. The merger of the Railway Budget with the Union Budget took place in:

(a) 2014 (b) 2016
(c) 2017 (d) 2019

Answer: (c) 2017; the separate railway budget dated from 1924 (Acworth Committee).

Q270. The World Trade Organization came into existence on:

(a) 1 January 1995 (b) 1 January 1948
(c) 15 April 1994 (d) 1 July 1997

Answer: (a) Replaced GATT; HQ Geneva.

Q271. The 'soft-loan window' of the World Bank is:

(a) IBRD (b) IDA
(c) IFC (d) MIGA

Answer: (b) International Development Association – interest-free/low-interest loans to poor countries.

Q272. The Bretton Woods Conference (1944) led to the creation of:

(a) WTO and UN (b) IMF and World Bank
(c) ADB and AIIB (d) OECD and OPEC

Answer: (b) Both are headquartered in Washington DC.

5.5 Schemes, Census and Agriculture

Q273. MGNREGA guarantees how many days of wage employment per household per year?

(a) 50 (b) 100
(c) 150 (d) 200

Answer: (b) Enacted 2005; launched 2 February 2006 at Anantapur.

Q274. Under PM-KISAN, eligible farmers receive per year:

(a) ₹2,000 (b) ₹4,000
(c) ₹6,000 (d) ₹12,000

Answer: (c) In three instalments of ₹2,000 each; launched 2019.

Q275. Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana provides:

(a) Tap water (b) LPG connections
(c) Electricity (d) Toilets

Answer: (b) Launched 1 May 2016 at Ballia, UP, for BPL women.

Q276. The sex ratio of India as per Census 2011 is:

(a) 933 (b) 940
(c) 943 (d) 950

Answer: (c) Kerala highest (1084), Haryana lowest (879).

Q277. Which state had the highest literacy rate in Census 2011?

(a) Mizoram (b) Kerala
(c) Goa (d) Tripura

Answer: (b) Kerala ≈ 94%; Bihar lowest ≈ 61.8%.

Q278. Operation Flood is related to:

(a) Fisheries (b) Milk production
(c) Flood control (d) Food grains

Answer: (b) White Revolution, led by Verghese Kurien (NDDB, 1970).

Q279. The Yellow Revolution is related to:

(a) Eggs (b) Oilseeds
(c) Honey (d) Fruits

Answer: (b) Silver – eggs/poultry; Golden – horticulture/honey; Blue – fish.

Q280. Which crop is a kharif crop?

(a) Wheat (b) Mustard
(c) Rice (d) Gram

Answer: (c) Kharif crops are sown with the monsoon (rice, cotton, maize); wheat, mustard, gram are rabi.

CHAPTER 6

Part B – Geography Practice MCQs

6.1 India – Physical

Q281. The Tropic of Cancer passes through how many Indian states?

(a) 6 (b) 7
(c) 8 (d) 9

Answer: (c) Gujarat, Rajasthan, MP, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Tripura, Mizoram.

Q282. India's Standard Meridian (82°30'E) passes through:

(a) Allahabad (b) Mirzapur
(c) Varanasi (d) Jabalpur

Answer: (b) IST = GMT + 5:30.

Q283. India shares its longest land border with:

(a) China (b) Pakistan
(c) Bangladesh (d) Nepal

Answer: (c) About 4,096 km; Afghanistan is the shortest (≈ 106 km).

Q284. The Palk Strait separates India from:

(a) Maldives (b) Sri Lanka
(c) Myanmar (d) Indonesia

Answer: (b) Adam's Bridge (Ram Setu) lies in the Palk Bay–Gulf of Mannar region.

Q285. The Ten Degree Channel separates:

(a) Andaman from Nicobar (b) Lakshadweep from Minicoy
(c) Minicoy from Maldives (d) India from Sri Lanka

Answer: (a) Nine Degree Channel separates Lakshadweep (Kavaratti) from Minicoy; Eight Degree Channel separates Minicoy from the Maldives.

Q286. The highest peak in India is:

(a) K2 (b) Kangchenjunga
(c) Nanda Devi (d) Kamet

Answer: (b) 8,586 m in Sikkim. K2 (8,611 m) lies in PoK, which India claims.

Q287. The highest peak of South India is:

(a) Doddabetta (b) Anamudi
(c) Mahendragiri (d) Guru Shikhar

Answer: (b) Anamudi (2,695 m), Kerala. Doddabetta is the highest in the Nilgiris.

Q288. The oldest fold mountains in India are the:

(a) Himalayas (b) Aravallis
(c) Vindhyas (d) Satpuras

Answer: (b) Highest peak Guru Shikhar (Mount Abu).

Q289. India's only active volcano is:

(a) Narcondam (b) Barren Island
(c) Baratang (d) Saddle Peak

Answer: (b) In the Andaman Sea.

Q290. Zoji La pass connects:

(a) Srinagar and Leh (b) Manali and Leh
(c) Sikkim and Tibet (d) Shimla and Tibet

Answer: (a) Zojila Tunnel is being built under it.

Q291. Nathu La pass is located in:

(a) Arunachal Pradesh (b) Sikkim
(c) Himachal Pradesh (d) Uttarakhand

Answer: (b) Old silk route; border trade reopened in 2006.

Q292. Shipki La pass is in:

(a) Himachal Pradesh (b) Uttarakhand
(c) Ladakh (d) Sikkim

Answer: (a) The Sutlej enters India here.

Q293. Which plain is formed by new alluvium?

(a) Bhabar (b) Terai
(c) Bhangar (d) Khadar

Answer: (d) Khadar – floodplains, fertile. Bhangar – old alluvium with kankar.

Q294. Chilika Lake, the largest brackish-water lagoon of India, is in:

(a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Odisha
(c) Tamil Nadu (d) West Bengal

Answer: (b) One of India's first Ramsar sites (1981).

Q295. The largest freshwater lake of India is:

(a) Dal (b) Wular
(c) Loktak (d) Vembanad

Answer: (b) Wular (J&K), on the Jhelum.

Q296. Sambhar Lake, the largest inland saline lake, is in:

(a) Gujarat (b) Rajasthan
(c) Haryana (d) Ladakh

Answer: (b) Rajasthan; a major salt source.

6.2 Rivers, Climate, Soils

Q297. The Narmada river originates at:

(a) Mahabaleshwar (b) Amarkantak
(c) Trimbakeshwar (d) Multai

Answer: (b) The Son also rises at Amarkantak; the Tapi at Multai.

Q298. The longest river of peninsular India is:

(a) Krishna (b) Godavari
(c) Kaveri (d) Mahanadi

Answer: (b) ≈ 1,465 km; called 'Dakshin Ganga'.

Q299. Which river flows westward through a rift valley?

(a) Godavari (b) Krishna
(c) Narmada (d) Mahanadi

Answer: (c) Narmada and Tapi flow west through rift valleys and form estuaries.

Q300. Which river is called the 'Sorrow of Bihar'?

(a) Gandak (b) Kosi
(c) Son (d) Ghaghara

Answer: (b) Due to frequent floods and course changes. Damodar is the 'Sorrow of Bengal'.

Q301. The Hirakud dam is built on the:

(a) Godavari (b) Mahanadi
(c) Krishna (d) Damodar

Answer: (b) Odisha; one of the longest earthen dams.

Q302. The highest dam in India is:

(a) Bhakra (b) Tehri
(c) Sardar Sarovar (d) Idukki

Answer: (b) Tehri (Uttarakhand), on the Bhagirathi.

Q303. Majuli, the largest river island in India, is on the:

(a) Ganga (b) Brahmaputra
(c) Godavari (d) Mahanadi

Answer: (b) Assam; India's first island district (2016).

Q304. Jog Falls is on the river:

(a) Kaveri (b) Sharavati
(c) Mandovi (d) Tungabhadra

Answer: (b) Karnataka.

Q305. Which place receives the highest average rainfall in the world?

(a) Cherrapunji (b) Mawsynram
(c) Agumbe (d) Pasighat

Answer: (b) Mawsynram, Meghalaya.

Q306. Tamil Nadu gets most of its rainfall from the:

(a) South-west monsoon (b) North-east (retreating) monsoon
(c) Western disturbances (d) Kalbaisakhi

Answer: (b) October–December.

Q307. 'Kalbaisakhi' are thunderstorms of:

(a) Kerala (b) West Bengal
(c) Punjab (d) Rajasthan

Answer: (b) Also called nor'westers; useful for tea, jute and rice.

Q308. Black (regur) soil is most suitable for:

(a) Rice (b) Cotton
(c) Tea (d) Wheat

Answer: (b) Formed from basalt (Deccan Trap); high moisture retention; self-ploughing.

Q309. Laterite soil forms due to:

(a) Wind erosion (b) Intense leaching
(c) Glacial deposition (d) Salinity

Answer: (b) In high-rainfall areas; used to grow tea, coffee and cashew.

Q310. The red colour of red soil is due to:

(a) Aluminium (b) Iron oxide
(c) Humus (d) Magnesium

Answer: (b) Ferric oxide; turns yellow when hydrated.

6.3 Parks, Resources, Transport

Q311. Kaziranga National Park is famous for:

(a) Asiatic lion (b) One-horned rhinoceros
(c) Hangul (d) Snow leopard

Answer: (b) Assam; UNESCO site.

Q312. Gir National Park is the only home of the:

(a) Bengal tiger (b) Asiatic lion
(c) Cheetah (d) Great Indian Bustard

Answer: (b) Gujarat.

Q313. The Hangul (Kashmir stag) is found in:

(a) Hemis (b) Dachigam
(c) Dudhwa (d) Manas

Answer: (b) Dachigam National Park, J&K.

Q314. Keibul Lamjao, the only floating national park, is in:

(a) Assam (b) Manipur
(c) Mizoram (d) Tripura

Answer: (b) On Loktak Lake; home of the Sangai deer.

Q315. India's first national park is:

(a) Kanha (b) Jim Corbett
(c) Gir (d) Periyar

Answer: (b) Established in 1936 as Hailey National Park; Project Tiger launched here (1973).

Q316. Cheetahs were reintroduced in India in 2022 at:

(a) Ranthambore (b) Kuno National Park
(c) Gir (d) Bandhavgarh

Answer: (b) Madhya Pradesh; cheetahs from Namibia and South Africa.

Q317. The first biosphere reserve of India is:

(a) Nanda Devi (b) Nilgiri
(c) Sundarbans (d) Gulf of Mannar

Answer: (b) 1986.

Q318. Silent Valley National Park is known for the:

(a) Lion-tailed macaque (b) Nilgiri tahr
(c) Red panda (d) Golden langur

Answer: (a) Kerala; tropical evergreen forest. Eravikulam is famous for the Nilgiri tahr.

Q319. Jharia is famous for:

(a) Iron ore (b) Coking coal
(c) Mica (d) Copper

Answer: (b) Jharkhand; largest coking coal field.

Q320. Kolar in Karnataka is famous for:

(a) Gold (b) Copper
(c) Manganese (d) Mica

Answer: (a) Kolar Gold Fields closed in 2001; Hutti is active.

Q321. Jaduguda in Jharkhand is known for:

(a) Uranium (b) Thorium
(c) Bauxite (d) Copper

Answer: (a) India's first uranium mine.

Q322. Which steel plant was set up with Soviet assistance?

(a) Rourkela (b) Durgapur
(c) Bhilai (d) TISCO

Answer: (c) Bhilai (Chhattisgarh) and Bokaro – USSR; Rourkela – West Germany; Durgapur – UK.

Q323. India's first nuclear power plant is at:

(a) Kalpakkam (b) Tarapur
(c) Rawatbhata (d) Narora

Answer: (b) Maharashtra, 1969.

Q324. Which state is the largest producer of coffee in India?

(a) Kerala (b) Karnataka
(c) Tamil Nadu (d) Assam

Answer: (b) About 70% of India's coffee.

Q325. Which state is the largest producer of natural rubber?

(a) Karnataka (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) Kerala (d) Tripura

Answer: (c) Tripura is second.

Q326. The longest national highway in India is:

(a) NH-27 (b) NH-44
(c) NH-48 (d) NH-19

Answer: (b) Srinagar to Kanyakumari (≈ 4,112 km).

Q327. National Waterway 1 runs on the:

(a) Brahmaputra (b) Ganga
(c) Godavari (d) West Coast Canal

Answer: (b) Prayagraj to Haldia; NW-2 is on the Brahmaputra.

Q328. The deepest landlocked natural harbour in India is:

(a) Kandla (b) Visakhapatnam
(c) Kochi (d) Mumbai

Answer: (b) Andhra Pradesh. Kandla (Deendayal) is a tidal port.

6.4 World and Physical Geography

Q329. The hottest planet in the solar system is:

(a) Mercury (b) Venus
(c) Mars (d) Jupiter

Answer: (b) Its thick CO_2 atmosphere traps heat (greenhouse effect).

Q330. The largest moon in the solar system is:

(a) Titan (b) Ganymede
(c) Europa (d) Moon

Answer: (b) Ganymede, a moon of Jupiter.

Q331. Pluto was reclassified as a dwarf planet in:

(a) 2000 (b) 2006
(c) 2010 (d) 2015

Answer: (b) By the International Astronomical Union.

Q332. The ozone layer lies in the:

(a) Troposphere (b) Stratosphere
(c) Mesosphere (d) Thermosphere

Answer: (b) About 15–35 km; absorbs UV radiation.

Q333. Meteors burn up in which layer of the atmosphere?

(a) Troposphere (b) Stratosphere
(c) Mesosphere (d) Exosphere

Answer: (c) The mesosphere is also the coldest layer.

Q334. The Chinook is a warm local wind of:

(a) Alps (b) Rocky Mountains
(c) Andes (d) Sahara

Answer: (b) Called the 'snow eater'. Foehn – Alps; Sirocco – Sahara to Italy.

Q335. Tropical cyclones are called 'typhoons' in the:

(a) Atlantic Ocean (b) Western Pacific / China Sea
(c) Indian Ocean (d) Caribbean

Answer: (b) Hurricanes – Atlantic/Caribbean; cyclones – Indian Ocean; willy-willies – Australia.

Q336. The deepest point in the world's oceans is the:

(a) Puerto Rico Trench (b) Java Trench
(c) Challenger Deep, Mariana Trench (d) Tonga Trench

Answer: (c) About 10,994 m, western Pacific.

Q337. The Gulf Stream is a:

(a) Cold current of the Pacific (b) Warm current of the Atlantic
(c) Cold current of the Atlantic (d) Warm current of the Indian Ocean

Answer: (b) Keeps north-west Europe warm; meets the cold Labrador current near Newfoundland (Grand Banks).

Q338. The longest river in the world is the:

(a) Amazon (b) Nile
(c) Yangtze (d) Mississippi

Answer: (b) About 6,650 km. The Amazon has the largest discharge.

Q339. The Strait of Gibraltar connects the Atlantic Ocean with the:

(a) Red Sea (b) Mediterranean Sea
(c) Black Sea (d) Arabian Sea

Answer: (b) Separates Spain from Morocco.

Q340. The Strait of Hormuz connects the Persian Gulf with the:

(a) Red Sea (b) Gulf of Oman
(c) Arabian Sea directly (d) Caspian Sea

Answer: (b) A key oil shipping route.

Q341. The 38th Parallel is the boundary between:

(a) USA and Canada (b) North and South Korea
(c) China and Mongolia (d) Germany and Poland

Answer: (b) The 49th Parallel separates the USA and Canada.

Q342. 'Pampas' are temperate grasslands of:

(a) Australia (b) Argentina
(c) South Africa (d) Russia

Answer: (b) Prairies – N. America; Steppes – Eurasia; Veld – South Africa; Downs – Australia.

Q343. The driest desert in the world is the:

(a) Sahara (b) Atacama
(c) Gobi (d) Kalahari

Answer: (b) Chile.

Q344. The parliament of Japan is called the:

(a) Knesset (b) Diet
(c) Duma (d) Majlis

Answer: (b) Knesset – Israel; Duma – Russia; Majlis – Iran.

Q345. The currency of Bhutan is the:

(a) Rupee (b) Taka
(c) Ngultrum (d) Kyat

Answer: (c) Taka – Bangladesh; Kyat – Myanmar; Rufiyaa – Maldives.

Q346. 1° of longitude corresponds to a time difference of:

(a) 1 minute (b) 4 minutes
(c) 15 minutes (d) 1 hour

Answer: (b) 360° = 24 h → 15° = 1 h.

Q347. The longest day in the Northern Hemisphere is:

(a) 21 March (b) 21 June
(c) 23 September (d) 22 December

Answer: (b) Summer solstice; the Sun is overhead at the Tropic of Cancer.

Q348. The crust–mantle boundary is called the:

(a) Gutenberg discontinuity (b) Moho discontinuity
(c) Conrad discontinuity (d) Lehmann discontinuity

Answer: (b) Gutenberg is the mantle–core boundary.

CHAPTER 7

Part B – Physics Practice MCQs

7.1 Units and Mechanics

Q349. The SI unit of pressure is:

(a) Newton (b) Pascal
(c) Bar (d) Atmosphere

Answer: (b) 1 Pa = 1 N/m²; 1 atm ≈ 1.013 × 10⁵ Pa.

Q350. The SI unit of magnetic flux density is:

(a) Weber (b) Tesla
(c) Gauss (d) Henry

Answer: (b) 1 T = 1 Wb/m² = 10⁴ gauss.

Q351. Which is NOT an SI base unit?

(a) Kelvin (b) Candela
(c) Newton (d) Mole

Answer: (c) Newton is derived (kg·m/s²). The seven base units: m, kg, s, A, K, mol, cd.

Q352. The SI unit of luminous intensity is:

(a) Lumen (b) Lux
(c) Candela (d) Watt

Answer: (c) Lumen – luminous flux; lux – illuminance.

Q353. A light year is a unit of:

(a) Time (b) Distance
(c) Speed (d) Intensity of light

Answer: (b) Distance light travels in one year ≈ 9.46 × 10¹² km.

Q354. One nautical mile is equal to:

(a) 1,609 m (b) 1,852 m
(c) 1,000 m (d) 2,000 m

Answer: (b) Used in sea and air navigation; speed in knots.

Q355. At what temperature do the Celsius and Fahrenheit scales read the same?

(a) 0° (b) −40°
(c) 40° (d) −273°

Answer: (b) °F = 1.8°C + 32 → x = 1.8x + 32 → x = −40.

Q356. Which is a vector quantity?

(a) Speed (b) Work
(c) Momentum (d) Energy

Answer: (c) Momentum has direction; speed, work and energy are scalars.

Q357. A rocket works on the principle of conservation of:

(a) Mass (b) Energy
(c) Linear momentum (d) Angular momentum

Answer: (c) Also Newton's third law.

Q358. The value of g is maximum at the:

(a) Equator (b) Poles
(c) Centre of the Earth (d) Tropic of Cancer

Answer: (b) Earth is flattened at the poles; g is zero at the centre.

Q359. The escape velocity from the Earth's surface is about:

(a) 7.9 km/s (b) 11.2 km/s
(c) 15 km/s (d) 3 km/s

Answer: (b) It does not depend on the mass of the escaping body; orbital velocity near Earth ≈ 7.9 km/s.

Q360. The time period of a simple pendulum depends on:

(a) Mass of the bob (b) Length of the pendulum
(c) Amplitude (small) (d) Material of the bob

Answer: (b) $T = 2\pi\sqrt{(l/g)}$.

Q361. If the velocity of a body is doubled, its kinetic energy becomes:

(a) Double (b) Half
(c) Four times (d) Unchanged

Answer: (c) $KE = \frac{1}{2}mv^2$.

Q362. A geostationary satellite completes one revolution in:

(a) 12 hours (b) 24 hours
(c) 90 minutes (d) 365 days

Answer: (b) At about 36,000 km above the equator, moving west to east.

Q363. Hydraulic lifts and brakes work on:

(a) Archimedes' principle (b) Pascal's law
(c) Bernoulli's principle (d) Hooke's law

Answer: (b) Pressure is transmitted equally in all directions.

Q364. The lift of an aeroplane wing is explained by:

(a) Pascal's law (b) Bernoulli's principle
(c) Newton's first law (d) Archimedes' principle

Answer: (b) Faster air over the wing → lower pressure above.

Q365. A lactometer is used to test the:

(a) Fat in milk (b) Purity of milk
(c) Temperature of milk (d) Acidity of milk

Answer: (b) Measures density (specific gravity) of milk.

Q366. Soap and detergents clean clothes because they:

(a) Increase surface tension (b) Reduce surface tension
(c) Increase viscosity (d) Raise boiling point

Answer: (b) Lower surface tension lets water wet fabric.

7.2 Heat and Sound

Q367. Water has maximum density at:

(a) 0 °C (b) 4 °C
(c) 100 °C (d) −4 °C

Answer: (b) Anomalous expansion; lakes freeze from the top.

Q368. Steam at 100 °C causes more severe burns than water at 100 °C because of:

(a) Higher specific heat (b) Latent heat of vaporisation
(c) Higher temperature (d) Higher density

Answer: (b) About 540 cal/g extra released on condensation.

Q369. A pressure cooker cooks food faster because:

(a) It reduces pressure (b) It raises the boiling point of water
(c) It lowers the boiling point (d) It increases heat conduction

Answer: (b) Higher pressure → higher boiling point.

Q370. Sea breeze blows:

(a) From land to sea during the day (b) From sea to land during the day
(c) From sea to land at night (d) Only in winter

Answer: (b) Land heats faster by day, creating low pressure over land.

Q371. Sound cannot travel through:

(a) Water (b) Steel
(c) Vacuum (d) Air

Answer: (c) Sound is a mechanical wave and needs a medium.

Q372. Sound travels fastest in:

(a) Air (b) Water
(c) Steel (d) Vacuum

Answer: (c) Solids > liquids > gases.

Q373. The audible range of human hearing is:

(a) 2 Hz–2,000 Hz (b) 20 Hz–20,000 Hz
(c) 200 Hz–200 kHz (d) 20 kHz–200 kHz

Answer: (b) Below is infrasonic; above is ultrasonic.

Q374. Bats navigate using:

(a) Infrasonic waves (b) Ultrasonic waves
(c) Radio waves (d) Infrared rays

Answer: (b) Echolocation.

Q375. The apparent change in frequency of a moving source of sound is called the:

(a) Raman effect (b) Doppler effect
(c) Tyndall effect (d) Compton effect

Answer: (b) E.g., the pitch of an ambulance siren rises as it approaches.

Q376. The pitch of a sound depends on its:

(a) Amplitude (b) Frequency
(c) Speed (d) Wavelength alone in vacuum

Answer: (b) Loudness depends on amplitude.

Q377. SONAR uses:

(a) Radio waves (b) Microwaves
(c) Ultrasonic waves (d) Infrared waves

Answer: (c) Sound Navigation and Ranging – measures sea depth and detects submarines.

7.3 Light and Optics

Q378. The mirror used as a rear-view mirror in vehicles is:

(a) Plane (b) Concave
(c) Convex (d) Cylindrical

Answer: (c) Gives a wider field of view with erect, diminished images.

Q379. Dentists and shaving mirrors use:

(a) Convex mirrors (b) Concave mirrors
(c) Plane mirrors (d) Parabolic convex mirrors

Answer: (b) Give an enlarged, erect image when the object is within focus.

Q380. Myopia (short-sightedness) is corrected by a:

(a) Convex lens (b) Concave lens
(c) Cylindrical lens (d) Bifocal lens

Answer: (b) The image forms in front of the retina; a diverging lens pushes it back.

Q381. The power of a convex lens of focal length 50 cm is:

(a) +0.5 D (b) +2 D
(c) −2 D (d) +50 D

Answer: (b) P = 1/f (in metres) = 1/0.5 = +2 D.

Q382. The sky appears blue because of:

(a) Reflection (b) Refraction
(c) Scattering of light (d) Dispersion

Answer: (c) Rayleigh scattering ∝ $1/\lambda^4$ – blue scatters more than red.

Q383. The sparkling of a diamond is due to:

(a) Dispersion only (b) Total internal reflection
(c) Diffraction (d) Polarisation

Answer: (b) Diamond has a very small critical angle (≈ 24°).

Q384. Optical fibres work on the principle of:

(a) Refraction (b) Total internal reflection
(c) Diffraction (d) Interference

Answer: (b) Used in telecommunication and endoscopy.

Q385. Stars twinkle because of:

(a) Reflection (b) Atmospheric refraction
(c) Scattering (d) Dispersion

Answer: (b) Changing air density bends starlight; planets twinkle less.

Q386. Danger signals are red because red light:

(a) Is scattered the most (b) Is scattered the least
(c) Has the highest frequency (d) Is absorbed by fog

Answer: (b) Longest wavelength in the visible range → travels farthest.

Q387. The Raman Effect, discovered by C.V. Raman, is related to:

(a) Reflection of sound (b) Scattering of light
(c) Radioactivity (d) Magnetism

Answer: (b) Nobel Prize 1930; National Science Day 28 February.

7.4 Electricity and Modern Physics

Q388. A fuse wire must have:

(a) High resistance and high melting point (b) Low melting point
(c) High melting point only (d) Low resistance and high melting point

Answer: (b) Usually an alloy of tin and lead, connected in series.

Q389. The filament of an electric bulb is made of:

(a) Nichrome (b) Tungsten
(c) Copper (d) Iron

Answer: (b) Very high melting point (≈ 3,422 °C).

Q390. Domestic electrical appliances are connected in:

(a) Series (b) Parallel
(c) Mixed (d) Either

Answer: (b) Each appliance gets full voltage and can be switched independently.

Q391. The frequency of AC mains supply in India is:

(a) 50 Hz (b) 60 Hz
(c) 100 Hz (d) 220 Hz

Answer: (a) 230 V, 50 Hz. The USA uses 120 V, 60 Hz.

Q392. A transformer works on:

(a) DC only (b) AC only
(c) Both AC and DC (d) Battery power

Answer: (b) Principle of mutual induction.

Q393. An electric motor converts:

(a) Mechanical energy to electrical (b) Electrical energy to mechanical
(c) Chemical energy to electrical (d) Heat to electrical

Answer: (b) A generator does the reverse.

Q394. The commercial unit of electrical energy is the:

(a) Joule (b) Watt
(c) Kilowatt-hour (d) Volt

Answer: (c) 1 unit = 1 kWh = 3.6×10^6 J.

Q395. The neutron was discovered by:

(a) J.J. Thomson (b) Rutherford
(c) James Chadwick (d) Niels Bohr

Answer: (c) 1932. Electron – Thomson (1897); nucleus – Rutherford (1911).

Q396. The energy of the Sun is produced by:

(a) Nuclear fission (b) Nuclear fusion
(c) Combustion (d) Radioactive decay

Answer: (b) Hydrogen nuclei fuse to form helium.

Q397. X-rays were discovered by:

(a) Henri Becquerel (b) Wilhelm Röntgen
(c) Marie Curie (d) Max Planck

Answer: (b) 1895; first Nobel in Physics (1901).

Q398. TV remote controls generally use:

(a) Ultraviolet rays (b) Infrared rays
(c) X-rays (d) Microwaves

Answer: (b) IR LEDs send coded pulses.

CHAPTER 8

Part B – Chemistry Practice MCQs

8.1 Matter, Atoms, Periodic Table

Q399. Which substance sublimes on heating?

(a) Sodium chloride (b) Camphor
(c) Sugar (d) Wax

Answer: (b) Also naphthalene, iodine, dry ice and ammonium chloride.

Q400. Milk is an example of:

(a) True solution (b) Colloid (emulsion)
(c) Suspension (d) Compound

Answer: (b) Shows the Tyndall effect.

Q401. Cream is separated from milk by:

(a) Filtration (b) Centrifugation
(c) Distillation (d) Sublimation

Answer: (b) Spinning separates lighter fat.

Q402. Isotopes have the same:

(a) Mass number (b) Number of neutrons
(c) Atomic number (d) Physical properties

Answer: (c) E.g., protium, deuterium, tritium.

Q403. The modern periodic law is based on:

(a) Atomic mass (b) Atomic number
(c) Number of neutrons (d) Valency

Answer: (b) Henry Moseley. Mendeleev's table was based on atomic mass.

Q404. The most electronegative element is:

(a) Oxygen (b) Chlorine
(c) Fluorine (d) Nitrogen

Answer: (c) Electronegativity increases across a period and decreases down a group.

Q405. Which metal is liquid at room temperature?

(a) Sodium (b) Mercury
(c) Gallium (d) Bromine

Answer: (b) Bromine is the liquid non-metal.

Q406. The lightest metal is:

(a) Sodium (b) Lithium
(c) Aluminium (d) Magnesium

Answer: (b) Hydrogen is the lightest element.

Q407. Which metal is stored in kerosene?

(a) Iron (b) Sodium
(c) Calcium (d) Aluminium

Answer: (b) Sodium and potassium react vigorously with air and water.

Q408. The best conductor of electricity among metals is:

(a) Copper (b) Gold
(c) Silver (d) Aluminium

Answer: (c) Copper is used in wires because it is cheaper.

Q409. Noble gases are in group:

(a) 1 (b) 2
(c) 17 (d) 18

Answer: (d) Inert due to complete outer shells.

Q410. Which gas is used in advertisement signs for a red glow?

(a) Argon (b) Neon
(c) Helium (d) Xenon

Answer: (b) Helium is used in balloons and deep-sea diving.

Q411. The most abundant element in the Earth's crust is:

(a) Silicon (b) Oxygen
(c) Aluminium (d) Iron

Answer: (b) Aluminium is the most abundant metal in the crust.

Q412. Avogadro's number is approximately:

(a) 6.022×10^{23} (b) 3×10^{8}
(c) 1.6×10^{-19} (d) 9.1×10^{-31}

Answer: (a) Particles in one mole.

8.2 Acids, Bases, Salts

Q413. The acid present in ant stings is:

(a) Acetic acid (b) Formic acid
(c) Citric acid (d) Lactic acid

Answer: (b) Treated with baking soda.

Q414. The acid present in tomato is:

(a) Tartaric acid (b) Oxalic acid
(c) Malic acid (d) Citric acid

Answer: (b) Calcium oxalate forms kidney stones.

Q415. The acid in curd is:

(a) Lactic acid (b) Citric acid
(c) Acetic acid (d) Butyric acid

Answer: (a) Also produced in muscles during exercise.

Q416. Tamarind contains:

(a) Malic acid (b) Tartaric acid
(c) Oxalic acid (d) Formic acid

Answer: (b) Grapes also contain tartaric acid.

Q417. Vinegar contains:

(a) Citric acid (b) Acetic acid
(c) Lactic acid (d) Hydrochloric acid

Answer: (b) About 5–8% acetic acid.

Q418. The pH of human blood is about:

(a) 6.4 (b) 7.0
(c) 7.4 (d) 8.4

Answer: (c) Slightly basic.

Q419. The acid present in the human stomach is:

(a) Sulphuric acid (b) Nitric acid
(c) Hydrochloric acid (d) Acetic acid

Answer: (c) It kills germs and activates pepsin.

Q420. Phenolphthalein turns pink in a:

(a) Acidic solution (b) Basic solution
(c) Neutral solution (d) Salt solution

Answer: (b) It is colourless in acids.

Q421. Aqua regia is a mixture of conc. HCl and conc. HNO_3 in the ratio:

(a) 1:3 (b) 3:1
(c) 1:1 (d) 2:1

Answer: (b) It dissolves gold and platinum.

Q422. The chemical name of baking soda is:

(a) Sodium carbonate (b) Sodium bicarbonate
(c) Sodium chloride (d) Sodium hydroxide

Answer: (b) $NaHCO_3$; used in baking and as an antacid.

Q423. Washing soda is:

(a) $NaHCO_3$ (b) $Na_2CO_3 \cdot 10H_2O$
(c) NaOH (d) $CaOCl_2$

Answer: (b) Used to remove the permanent hardness of water.

Q424. The chemical formula of Plaster of Paris is:

(a) $CaSO_4 \cdot 2H_2O$ (b) $CaSO_4 \cdot \frac{1}{2}H_2O$
(c) $CaCO_3$ (d) CaO

Answer: (b) Gypsum is $CaSO_4 \cdot 2H_2O$.

Q425. Bleaching powder is chemically:

(a) Calcium chloride (b) Calcium oxychloride
(c) Calcium carbonate (d) Sodium hypochlorite

Answer: (b) $CaOCl_2$; used to disinfect water.

Q426. Laughing gas is:

(a) Nitric oxide (b) Nitrous oxide
(c) Nitrogen dioxide (d) Ammonia

Answer: (b) N_2O; used as an anaesthetic.

Q427. Dry ice is solid:

(a) Water (b) Carbon dioxide
(c) Nitrogen (d) Ammonia

Answer: (b) Sublimes at −78.5 °C.

Q428. Indelible ink used in elections contains:

(a) Silver nitrate (b) Potassium permanganate
(c) Copper sulphate (d) Sodium chloride

Answer: (a) $AgNO_3$ stains the skin on exposure to light.

Q429. Blue vitriol is:

(a) Ferrous sulphate (b) Copper sulphate
(c) Zinc sulphate (d) Magnesium sulphate

Answer: (b) $CuSO_4 \cdot 5H_2O$. Green vitriol – $FeSO_4$; white vitriol – $ZnSO_4$.

Q430. Heavy water is used in nuclear reactors as a:

(a) Fuel (b) Moderator
(c) Coolant only (d) Control rod

Answer: (b) D_2O slows down neutrons.

8.3 Metals, Alloys, Everyday Chemistry

Q431. Brass is an alloy of:

(a) Copper and tin (b) Copper and zinc
(c) Iron and carbon (d) Lead and tin

Answer: (b) Bronze = copper + tin.

Q432. Solder is an alloy of:

(a) Lead and tin (b) Copper and zinc
(c) Iron and nickel (d) Aluminium and copper

Answer: (a) Low melting point; joins electrical wires.

Q433. Stainless steel contains iron, carbon and:

(a) Copper and zinc (b) Chromium and nickel
(c) Lead and tin (d) Aluminium

Answer: (b) Chromium forms a protective oxide layer.

Q434. German silver contains:

(a) Silver (b) Copper, zinc and nickel
(c) Copper and silver (d) Silver and nickel

Answer: (b) It contains no silver.

Q435. Galvanisation is coating iron with:

(a) Tin (b) Zinc
(c) Chromium (d) Copper

Answer: (b) Zinc protects iron from rusting even if scratched (sacrificial protection).

Q436. Bauxite is the ore of:

(a) Iron (b) Copper
(c) Aluminium (d) Zinc

Answer: (c) $Al_2O_3 \cdot 2H_2O$; extracted by electrolysis (Hall–Héroult).

Q437. Galena is the ore of:

(a) Lead (b) Mercury
(c) Zinc (d) Tin

Answer: (a) PbS. Cinnabar – mercury (HgS).

Q438. Pure gold is:

(a) 18 carat (b) 22 carat
(c) 24 carat (d) 20 carat

Answer: (c) 22 carat = 22 parts gold + 2 parts other metal.

Q439. The 'lead' in a pencil is:

(a) Lead (b) Graphite
(c) Charcoal (d) Carbon black

Answer: (b) Graphite mixed with clay.

Q440. The hardest natural substance is:

(a) Graphite (b) Diamond
(c) Quartz (d) Corundum

Answer: (b) Each carbon is bonded to four others in a 3-D network.

Q441. Vulcanisation of rubber involves heating it with:

(a) Carbon (b) Sulphur
(c) Phosphorus (d) Chlorine

Answer: (b) Charles Goodyear; makes rubber harder and more elastic.

Q442. The main constituent of LPG is:

(a) Methane (b) Butane
(c) Ethane (d) Hydrogen

Answer: (b) Butane with propane; ethyl mercaptan added for smell.

Q443. The main constituent of CNG and biogas is:

(a) Methane (b) Ethane
(c) Propane (d) Butane

Answer: (a) Methane (marsh gas).

Q444. The gas responsible for the Bhopal gas tragedy (1984) was:

(a) Phosgene (b) Methyl isocyanate
(c) Chlorine (d) Hydrogen cyanide

Answer: (b) Leaked from the Union Carbide plant.

Q445. Minamata disease is caused by:

(a) Cadmium (b) Lead
(c) Mercury (d) Arsenic

Answer: (c) Itai-itai is caused by cadmium.

Q446. Which gas is used for artificial ripening of fruits?

(a) Methane (b) Ethylene
(c) Acetylene only (d) Chlorine

Answer: (b) Ethylene is the natural ripening hormone; calcium carbide (which releases acetylene) is banned for ripening.

Q447. The non-stick coating on cookware is:

(a) PVC (b) Teflon
(c) Bakelite (d) Nylon

Answer: (b) Polytetrafluoroethylene.

Q448. Which polymer is thermosetting?

(a) Polythene (b) PVC
(c) Bakelite (d) Nylon

Answer: (c) Thermosets cannot be remoulded on heating.

Q449. The first fully synthetic fibre was:

(a) Rayon (b) Nylon
(c) Terylene (d) Acrylic

Answer: (b) Wallace Carothers (DuPont). Rayon is semi-synthetic (artificial silk).

Q450. Temporary hardness of water is due to:

(a) Chlorides of Ca and Mg (b) Bicarbonates of Ca and Mg
(c) Sulphates of Ca and Mg (d) Sodium chloride

Answer: (b) Removed by boiling or Clark's method.

Q451. Penicillin was discovered by:

(a) Louis Pasteur (b) Alexander Fleming
(c) Edward Jenner (d) Robert Koch

Answer: (b) 1928.

CHAPTER 9

Part B – Biology Practice MCQs

9.1 Cell and Classification

Q452. The cell was first discovered by:

(a) Robert Brown (b) Robert Hooke
(c) Leeuwenhoek (d) Schleiden

Answer: (b) 1665, in cork. Robert Brown discovered the nucleus (1831).

Q453. Which organelle is called the 'powerhouse of the cell'?

(a) Ribosome (b) Mitochondria
(c) Golgi body (d) Lysosome

Answer: (b) Produces ATP by aerobic respiration.

Q454. Lysosomes are known as:

(a) Protein factories (b) Suicide bags
(c) Powerhouses (d) Post offices

Answer: (b) Contain digestive enzymes.

Q455. Protein synthesis takes place in the:

(a) Mitochondria (b) Ribosomes
(c) Lysosomes (d) Vacuoles

Answer: (b) Ribosomes are non-membrane organelles.

Q456. Which organelles contain their own DNA?

(a) Ribosomes and lysosomes (b) Mitochondria and chloroplasts
(c) Golgi body and ER (d) Nucleolus and vacuole

Answer: (b) Called semi-autonomous organelles.

Q457. The plant cell wall is made of:

(a) Chitin (b) Cellulose
(c) Peptidoglycan (d) Protein

Answer: (b) Fungal walls – chitin; bacterial walls – peptidoglycan.

Q458. The double-helix model of DNA was proposed by:

(a) Mendel and Morgan (b) Watson and Crick
(c) Darwin and Wallace (d) Hooke and Brown

Answer: (b) 1953.

Q459. The number of chromosomes in a normal human cell is:

(a) 23 (b) 44
(c) 46 (d) 48

Answer: (c) 23 pairs: 22 autosomes + 1 pair of sex chromosomes.

Q460. The 'Father of Taxonomy' is:

(a) Darwin (b) Linnaeus
(c) Mendel (d) Aristotle

Answer: (b) Introduced binomial nomenclature.

Q461. The five-kingdom classification was proposed by:

(a) Linnaeus (b) R.H. Whittaker
(c) Haeckel (d) Carl Woese

Answer: (b) 1969: Monera, Protista, Fungi, Plantae, Animalia.

Q462. The scientific name of the mango is:

(a) Mangifera indica (b) Azadirachta indica
(c) Ficus benghalensis (d) Oryza sativa

Answer: (a) Neem – Azadirachta indica; banyan – Ficus benghalensis; rice – Oryza sativa.

Q463. Which is a mammal?

(a) Shark (b) Whale
(c) Penguin (d) Crocodile

Answer: (b) Whales breathe air through lungs and suckle their young.

Q464. Which mammal lays eggs?

(a) Kangaroo (b) Platypus
(c) Bat (d) Dolphin

Answer: (b) Platypus and echidna are monotremes.

Q465. Which group of plants is called the 'amphibians of the plant kingdom'?

(a) Algae (b) Bryophytes
(c) Pteridophytes (d) Gymnosperms

Answer: (b) They need water for fertilisation.

9.2 Nutrition and Vitamins

Q466. Night blindness is caused by deficiency of:

(a) Vitamin A (b) Vitamin B1
(c) Vitamin C (d) Vitamin D

Answer: (a) Retinol; needed for rhodopsin in rod cells.

Q467. Scurvy is caused by deficiency of:

(a) Vitamin A (b) Vitamin B12
(c) Vitamin C (d) Vitamin K

Answer: (c) Ascorbic acid; bleeding gums. Amla is the richest natural source.

Q468. Rickets is caused by deficiency of:

(a) Vitamin A (b) Vitamin D
(c) Vitamin E (d) Vitamin K

Answer: (b) Calciferol; made in the skin by sunlight.

Q469. Beriberi is caused by deficiency of:

(a) Thiamine (B1) (b) Riboflavin (B2)
(c) Niacin (B3) (d) Cobalamin (B12)

Answer: (a) Affects nerves and heart.

Q470. Pellagra is caused by deficiency of:

(a) Vitamin B1 (b) Vitamin B3 (niacin)
(c) Vitamin B6 (d) Vitamin C

Answer: (b) The 3 Ds – dermatitis, diarrhoea, dementia.

Q471. Which vitamin is essential for blood clotting?

(a) Vitamin A (b) Vitamin C
(c) Vitamin E (d) Vitamin K

Answer: (d) Also synthesised by intestinal bacteria.

Q472. Vitamin B12 contains which element?

(a) Iron (b) Cobalt
(c) Magnesium (d) Zinc

Answer: (b) Cobalamin; deficiency causes pernicious anaemia.

Q473. Which vitamins are fat-soluble?

(a) B and C (b) A, D, E and K
(c) A and C only (d) B-complex

Answer: (b) B-complex and C are water-soluble.

Q474. Goitre is caused by deficiency of:

(a) Iron (b) Calcium
(c) Iodine (d) Fluorine

Answer: (c) Iodine is needed to make thyroxine.

Q475. Kwashiorkor is caused by deficiency of:

(a) Carbohydrates (b) Proteins
(c) Fats (d) Vitamins

Answer: (b) Marasmus is deficiency of both protein and calories.

9.3 Human Body

Q476. The largest gland in the human body is the:

(a) Pancreas (b) Liver
(c) Thyroid (d) Pituitary

Answer: (b) Secretes bile; stores glycogen.

Q477. The 'master gland' of the body is the:

(a) Thyroid (b) Adrenal
(c) Pituitary (d) Pineal

Answer: (c) Controlled by the hypothalamus.

Q478. Insulin is secreted by the:

(a) Liver (b) Alpha cells of the pancreas
(c) Beta cells of the pancreas (d) Adrenal gland

Answer: (c) Lowers blood sugar. Glucagon (alpha cells) raises it.

Q479. Which hormone is called the 'emergency' or 'fight or flight' hormone?

(a) Thyroxine (b) Adrenaline
(c) Insulin (d) Oxytocin

Answer: (b) Secreted by the adrenal medulla.

Q480. Bile is produced by the:

(a) Gall bladder (b) Liver
(c) Pancreas (d) Stomach

Answer: (b) Stored in the gall bladder; emulsifies fats; contains no enzymes.

Q481. The longest bone in the human body is the:

(a) Tibia (b) Femur
(c) Humerus (d) Fibula

Answer: (b) The smallest is the stapes (middle ear).

Q482. An adult human has how many bones?

(a) 206 (b) 212
(c) 300 (d) 186

Answer: (a) A newborn has about 270–300.

Q483. The lifespan of a red blood cell is about:

(a) 30 days (b) 60 days
(c) 120 days (d) 365 days

Answer: (c) Made in red bone marrow; destroyed in the spleen and liver.

Q484. The universal blood donor group is:

(a) A (b) B
(c) AB (d) O

Answer: (d) O negative; AB positive is the universal recipient.

Q485. Blood groups were discovered by:

(a) William Harvey (b) Karl Landsteiner
(c) Robert Koch (d) Louis Pasteur

Answer: (b) 1900; Nobel Prize 1930.

Q486. The functional unit of the kidney is the:

(a) Neuron (b) Nephron
(c) Alveolus (d) Villus

Answer: (b) About a million per kidney.

Q487. Which part of the brain controls balance and posture?

(a) Cerebrum (b) Cerebellum
(c) Medulla oblongata (d) Hypothalamus

Answer: (b) Medulla controls involuntary actions like heartbeat and breathing.

Q488. Normal blood pressure of a healthy adult is about:

(a) 80/120 mm Hg (b) 120/80 mm Hg
(c) 140/90 mm Hg (d) 100/60 mm Hg

Answer: (b) Measured with a sphygmomanometer.

Q489. The pacemaker of the heart is the:

(a) AV node (b) SA node
(c) Bundle of His (d) Purkinje fibres

Answer: (b) Sino-atrial node.

Q490. The largest organ of the human body is the:

(a) Liver (b) Skin
(c) Brain (d) Lungs

Answer: (b) The liver is the largest internal organ (and gland).

9.4 Diseases and Health

Q491. Malaria is caused by:

(a) A virus (b) A bacterium
(c) Plasmodium (a protozoan) (d) A fungus

Answer: (c) Spread by the female Anopheles mosquito.

Q492. Dengue is spread by the mosquito:

(a) Anopheles (b) Culex
(c) Aedes aegypti (d) Mansonia

Answer: (c) Day-biting; falling platelet count.

Q493. Typhoid is diagnosed by the:

(a) ELISA test (b) Widal test
(c) Mantoux test (d) Schick test

Answer: (b) ELISA – HIV; Mantoux – TB; Schick – diphtheria.

Q494. Tuberculosis is caused by:

(a) Vibrio cholerae (b) Mycobacterium tuberculosis
(c) Salmonella typhi (d) Plasmodium

Answer: (b) Discovered by Robert Koch (1882); BCG vaccine.

Q495. Which disease is caused by a virus?

(a) Cholera (b) Typhoid
(c) Polio (d) Tuberculosis

Answer: (c) The others are bacterial.

Q496. The first vaccine (against smallpox) was developed by:

(a) Louis Pasteur (b) Edward Jenner
(c) Jonas Salk (d) Robert Koch

Answer: (b) 1796. Pasteur developed the rabies vaccine (1885).

Q497. HIV mainly attacks:

(a) Red blood cells (b) Helper T-cells (CD4)
(c) Platelets (d) B-cells only

Answer: (b) Weakens the immune system.

Q498. Kala-azar is transmitted by:

(a) Housefly (b) Sandfly
(c) Tsetse fly (d) Mosquito

Answer: (b) Caused by Leishmania donovani. Tsetse fly spreads sleeping sickness.

Q499. Down syndrome is due to trisomy of chromosome:

(a) 13 (b) 18
(c) 21 (d) X

Answer: (c) An extra copy of chromosome 21.

Q500. Silicosis is an occupational disease of:

(a) Coal miners (b) Stone and glass workers
(c) Cotton textile workers (d) Painters

Answer: (b) Byssinosis – cotton dust; anthracosis – coal dust.

Q501. India was declared polio-free by WHO in:

(a) 2011 (b) 2014
(c) 2016 (d) 2018

Answer: (b) The last case was in January 2011.

9.5 Plants, Genetics, Ecology

Q502. The edible part of the potato is a:

(a) Root (b) Stem (tuber)
(c) Leaf (d) Fruit

Answer: (b) Underground stem with 'eyes' (nodes). Sweet potato is a root.

Q503. Saffron is obtained from the:

(a) Petal (b) Stigma
(c) Seed (d) Root

Answer: (b) Of the Crocus sativus flower; grown at Pampore, Kashmir.

Q504. Clove is a dried:

(a) Fruit (b) Flower bud
(c) Seed (d) Bark

Answer: (b) Black pepper is a fruit; cinnamon is a bark.

Q505. The oxygen released during photosynthesis comes from:

(a) Carbon dioxide (b) Water
(c) Glucose (d) Chlorophyll

Answer: (b) Photolysis of water.

Q506. Which plant hormone is a gas?

(a) Auxin (b) Gibberellin
(c) Ethylene (d) Cytokinin

Answer: (c) Promotes fruit ripening.

Q507. Abscisic acid is known as the:

(a) Growth hormone (b) Stress hormone
(c) Ripening hormone (d) Flowering hormone

Answer: (b) Causes stomatal closure and dormancy.

Q508. Food is transported in plants by the:

(a) Xylem (b) Phloem
(c) Stomata (d) Root hairs

Answer: (b) Xylem carries water and minerals.

Q509. Rhizobium bacteria fix nitrogen in the root nodules of:

(a) Wheat (b) Leguminous plants
(c) Rice (d) Maize

Answer: (b) Peas, beans, groundnut.

Q510. Mendel conducted his experiments on:

(a) Fruit fly (b) Garden pea
(c) Maize (d) Tomato

Answer: (b) The phenotypic ratio in a monohybrid cross is 3:1.

Q511. 'Origin of Species' was written by:

(a) Lamarck (b) Charles Darwin
(c) Mendel (d) Hugo de Vries

Answer: (b) 1859; theory of natural selection.

Q512. The forelimbs of man, bat and whale are examples of:

(a) Analogous organs (b) Homologous organs
(c) Vestigial organs (d) Rudimentary organs

Answer: (b) Same origin, different functions (divergent evolution).

Q513. The 10% law of energy transfer in a food chain was given by:

(a) Tansley (b) Lindeman
(c) Odum (d) Haeckel

Answer: (b) Only about 10% of energy passes to the next trophic level.

Q514. The Chipko movement (1973) began in present-day:

(a) Himachal Pradesh (b) Uttarakhand
(c) Karnataka (d) Rajasthan

Answer: (b) Leaders included Sunderlal Bahuguna and Gaura Devi.

CHAPTER 10

Part B – Static GK Practice MCQs

10.1 Books and Authors

Q515. 'Gitanjali' was written by:

(a) Bankim Chandra Chatterjee (b) Rabindranath Tagore
(c) Sarat Chandra (d) Sarojini Naidu

Answer: (b) Nobel Prize in Literature 1913.

Q516. 'Anandamath' was written by:

(a) Rabindranath Tagore (b) Bankim Chandra Chatterjee
(c) Premchand (d) Aurobindo Ghosh

Answer: (b) Contains 'Vande Mataram'.

Q517. 'Godan' was written by:

(a) Jaishankar Prasad (b) Munshi Premchand
(c) Harivansh Rai Bachchan (d) Mahadevi Verma

Answer: (b) Also Gaban, Nirmala, Rangbhoomi.

Q518. 'Discovery of India' was written by:

(a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) Rajendra Prasad (d) B.R. Ambedkar

Answer: (b) Written in Ahmednagar Fort prison (1942–46).

Q519. 'Wings of Fire' is the autobiography of:

(a) Vikram Sarabhai (b) A.P.J. Abdul Kalam
(c) Homi Bhabha (d) Satish Dhawan

Answer: (b) Co-authored with Arun Tiwari.

Q520. 'Hind Swaraj' was written by:

(a) Tilak (b) Mahatma Gandhi
(c) Gokhale (d) Nehru

Answer: (b) 1909, in Gujarati, on board a ship.

Q521. 'Midnight's Children' was written by:

(a) V.S. Naipaul (b) Salman Rushdie
(c) Vikram Seth (d) Amitav Ghosh

Answer: (b) Booker Prize 1981.

Q522. 'The God of Small Things' was written by:

(a) Kiran Desai (b) Arundhati Roy
(c) Anita Desai (d) Jhumpa Lahiri

Answer: (b) Booker Prize 1997.

Q523. 'The White Tiger' was written by:

(a) Aravind Adiga (b) Chetan Bhagat
(c) Amitav Ghosh (d) Kiran Desai

Answer: (a) Booker Prize 2008.

Q524. 'Untouchable' was written by:

(a) Raja Rao (b) Mulk Raj Anand
(c) R.K. Narayan (d) Khushwant Singh

Answer: (b) Also 'Coolie'.

Q525. 'India Wins Freedom' was written by:

(a) Jawaharlal Nehru (b) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
(c) Sardar Patel (d) C. Rajagopalachari

Answer: (b) Autobiographical account of the freedom struggle.

Q526. 'Playing It My Way' is the autobiography of:

(a) Sunil Gavaskar (b) Sachin Tendulkar
(c) Kapil Dev (d) M.S. Dhoni

Answer: (b) Published 2014.

Q527. 'Unbreakable' is the autobiography of:

(a) Saina Nehwal (b) Mary Kom
(c) P.T. Usha (d) Sania Mirza

Answer: (b) Boxer, six-time world champion.

Q528. 'The Race of My Life' is the autobiography of:

(a) P.T. Usha (b) Milkha Singh
(c) Neeraj Chopra (d) Hima Das

Answer: (b) The 'Flying Sikh'.

Q529. 'Tamas', a novel on Partition, was written by:

(a) Bhisham Sahni (b) Yashpal
(c) Kamleshwar (d) Amrita Pritam

Answer: (a) Hindi; Sahitya Akademi Award 1975.

Q530. 'Kanthapura' was written by:

(a) R.K. Narayan (b) Raja Rao
(c) Mulk Raj Anand (d) Ruskin Bond

Answer: (b) 1938, Gandhian movement in a South Indian village.

Q531. Rajatarangini was written by:

(a) Kalhana (b) Bilhana
(c) Banabhatta (d) Jayadeva

Answer: (a) History of Kashmir, 12th century.

Q532. 'Gita Govinda' was composed by:

(a) Kalidasa (b) Jayadeva
(c) Surdas (d) Tulsidas

Answer: (b) Poet in Lakshmana Sena's court (Bengal).

10.2 Sports

Q533. The first Indian to win an individual Olympic gold medal was:

(a) Neeraj Chopra (b) Abhinav Bindra
(c) Sushil Kumar (d) Rajyavardhan Rathore

Answer: (b) 10 m air rifle, Beijing 2008.

Q534. Neeraj Chopra won the Olympic gold in javelin at:

(a) Rio 2016 (b) Tokyo 2020
(c) Paris 2024 (d) London 2012

Answer: (b) Held in 2021; India's first athletics gold. He won silver at Paris 2024.

Q535. The first Indian woman to win an Olympic medal was:

(a) P.T. Usha (b) Karnam Malleswari
(c) Saina Nehwal (d) Mary Kom

Answer: (b) Weightlifting bronze, Sydney 2000.

Q536. How many Olympic gold medals has the Indian men's hockey team won?

(a) 6 (b) 7
(c) 8 (d) 9

Answer: (c) 1928, 1932, 1936, 1948, 1952, 1956, 1964, 1980.

Q537. National Sports Day (29 August) commemorates:

(a) Milkha Singh (b) Dhyan Chand
(c) P.T. Usha (d) Sachin Tendulkar

Answer: (b) Hockey wizard's birthday.

Q538. How many players are there in a kabaddi team on court?

(a) 6 (b) 7
(c) 9 (d) 11

Answer: (b) Kho-kho: 9; volleyball: 6; polo: 4.

Q539. The term 'Bully' is used in:

(a) Football (b) Hockey
(c) Polo (d) Golf

Answer: (b) Starting play in field hockey (older rules).

Q540. 'Chukker' is associated with:

(a) Polo (b) Golf
(c) Billiards (d) Chess

Answer: (a) A period of play in polo.

Q541. 'Birdie' and 'Bogey' are terms of:

(a) Badminton (b) Golf
(c) Tennis (d) Squash

Answer: (b) Birdie – one under par; bogey – one over par.

Q542. The Ranji Trophy is associated with:

(a) Football (b) Hockey
(c) Cricket (d) Badminton

Answer: (c) Domestic first-class cricket.

Q543. The Durand Cup is associated with:

(a) Cricket (b) Football
(c) Hockey (d) Tennis

Answer: (b) Asia's oldest football tournament (1888).

Q544. The Thomas Cup is associated with:

(a) Tennis (b) Table tennis
(c) Badminton (d) Golf

Answer: (c) Men's team badminton; Uber Cup is for women.

Q545. Wimbledon is played on:

(a) Clay court (b) Grass court
(c) Hard court (d) Synthetic court

Answer: (b) The oldest Grand Slam (1877). French Open – clay.

Q546. India won the ICC Cricket World Cup (ODI) in:

(a) 1983 and 2011 (b) 1983 and 2007
(c) 2003 and 2011 (d) 1987 and 2011

Answer: (a) Captains Kapil Dev (1983) and M.S. Dhoni (2011).

Q547. The first modern Olympic Games were held in:

(a) Paris, 1900 (b) Athens, 1896
(c) London, 1908 (d) Stockholm, 1912

Answer: (b) Revived by Pierre de Coubertin.

Q548. The 'Flying Sikh' is:

(a) Milkha Singh (b) Harbhajan Singh
(c) Gurbachan Singh Randhawa (d) Kartar Singh

Answer: (a) 400 m runner; 4th at the 1960 Rome Olympics.

Q549. The 'Payyoli Express' refers to:

(a) Hima Das (b) P.T. Usha
(c) Dutee Chand (d) Anju Bobby George

Answer: (b) Missed a 1984 Olympic bronze by 1/100th of a second (400 m hurdles).

Q550. India's first Grandmaster in chess was:

(a) Koneru Humpy (b) Viswanathan Anand
(c) D. Gukesh (d) Pentala Harikrishna

Answer: (b) 1988.

Q551. The highest sports award of India is the:

(a) Arjuna Award (b) Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna
(c) Dronacharya Award (d) Padma Shri

Answer: (b) Dronacharya is for coaches.

10.3 Awards and Honours

Q552. The first recipients of the Bharat Ratna (1954) included:

(a) C.V. Raman (b) Mother Teresa
(c) J.R.D. Tata (d) Lata Mangeshkar

Answer: (a) Along with C. Rajagopalachari and S. Radhakrishnan.

Q553. The first sportsperson to receive the Bharat Ratna is:

(a) Dhyan Chand (b) Sachin Tendulkar
(c) Milkha Singh (d) Kapil Dev

Answer: (b) 2014.

Q554. The first foreigner to receive the Bharat Ratna was:

(a) Nelson Mandela (b) Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan
(c) Mother Teresa (d) Dalai Lama

Answer: (b) 1987. Mother Teresa was a naturalised Indian citizen (1980).

Q555. The Dadasaheb Phalke Award is given for contribution to:

(a) Literature (b) Cinema
(c) Music (d) Science

Answer: (b) First recipient Devika Rani (1969).

Q556. The first recipient of the Jnanpith Award was:

(a) Tarashankar Bandopadhyay (b) G. Sankara Kurup
(c) Amrita Pritam (d) Mahadevi Verma

Answer: (b) Malayalam poet, 1965 (for 'Odakkuzhal').

Q557. Which award is called 'Asia's Nobel Prize'?

(a) Gandhi Peace Prize (b) Ramon Magsaysay Award
(c) Kalinga Prize (d) Templeton Prize

Answer: (b) Philippines; first Indian recipient Vinoba Bhave (1958).

Q558. The Pritzker Prize is given for:

(a) Literature (b) Architecture
(c) Mathematics (d) Journalism

Answer: (b) B.V. Doshi (2018) was the first Indian.

Q559. The Fields Medal is given for:

(a) Physics (b) Mathematics
(c) Medicine (d) Peace

Answer: (b) Every four years, to mathematicians under 40.

Q560. The highest wartime gallantry award in India is the:

(a) Ashoka Chakra (b) Param Vir Chakra
(c) Maha Vir Chakra (d) Kirti Chakra

Answer: (b) First recipient Major Somnath Sharma (1947). Ashoka Chakra is the highest peacetime award.

Q561. The first Indian to win a Nobel Prize in Physics was:

(a) S. Chandrasekhar (b) C.V. Raman
(c) Har Gobind Khorana (d) Homi Bhabha

Answer: (b) 1930, for the Raman Effect.

10.4 National Symbols, Days, Organisations, Firsts

Q562. How many spokes does the Ashoka Chakra in the National Flag have?

(a) 12 (b) 16
(c) 24 (d) 32

Answer: (c) Navy blue; flag ratio 3:2.

Q563. The National Flag was adopted by the Constituent Assembly on:

(a) 15 August 1947 (b) 22 July 1947
(c) 26 January 1950 (d) 24 January 1950

Answer: (b) Based on Pingali Venkayya's design.

Q564. The playing time of the full National Anthem is about:

(a) 20 seconds (b) 52 seconds
(c) 60 seconds (d) 90 seconds

Answer: (b) Short version ≈ 20 seconds.

Q565. The National Aquatic Animal of India is the:

(a) Blue whale (b) Ganges river dolphin
(c) Gharial (d) Olive Ridley turtle

Answer: (b) Declared in 2009.

Q566. The National Heritage Animal of India is the:

(a) Tiger (b) Elephant
(c) Lion (d) Peacock

Answer: (b) Declared in 2010.

Q567. The National Calendar of India is based on the:

(a) Vikram Samvat (b) Saka era
(c) Hijri calendar (d) Gregorian calendar

Answer: (b) Adopted from 22 March 1957.

Q568. National Science Day is celebrated on:

(a) 28 February (b) 11 May
(c) 15 September (d) 22 December

Answer: (a) Raman Effect discovery (1928). 11 May – National Technology Day.

Q569. Engineers' Day (15 September) marks the birth anniversary of:

(a) Homi Bhabha (b) M. Visvesvaraya
(c) Vikram Sarabhai (d) A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

Answer: (b) Bharat Ratna 1955.

Q570. National Mathematics Day is celebrated on:

(a) 22 December (b) 14 March
(c) 5 September (d) 28 February

Answer: (a) Birth anniversary of Srinivasa Ramanujan.

Q571. The headquarters of UNESCO is in:

(a) New York (b) Geneva
(c) Paris (d) Rome

Answer: (c) WHO and ILO – Geneva; FAO – Rome.

Q572. The headquarters of the International Solar Alliance is in:

(a) New Delhi (b) Gurugram
(c) Paris (d) Bengaluru

Answer: (b) India–France initiative (2015).

Q573. The UN Security Council has how many permanent members?

(a) 5 (b) 10
(c) 15 (d) 7

Answer: (a) USA, UK, France, Russia, China – each has a veto.

Q574. The first Indian to go into space was:

(a) Kalpana Chawla (b) Rakesh Sharma
(c) Sunita Williams (d) Ravish Malhotra

Answer: (b) Soyuz T-11, 1984.

Q575. India's first satellite was:

(a) Rohini (b) Aryabhata
(c) Bhaskara (d) INSAT-1A

Answer: (b) Launched 19 April 1975 by a Soviet rocket.

Q576. Chandrayaan-3 landed near the Moon's south pole on:

(a) 14 July 2023 (b) 23 August 2023
(c) 2 September 2023 (d) 22 July 2019

Answer: (b) Lander Vikram, rover Pragyan; 23 August is National Space Day.

Q577. The first woman Chief Minister of an Indian state was:

(a) Indira Gandhi (b) Sucheta Kripalani
(c) Sarojini Naidu (d) J. Jayalalithaa

Answer: (b) Uttar Pradesh, 1963. Sarojini Naidu was the first woman Governor.

Q578. The first Indian talkie film was:

(a) Raja Harishchandra (b) Alam Ara
(c) Kisan Kanya (d) Devdas

Answer: (b) 1931, directed by Ardeshir Irani.

Q579. The 'father of the Indian space programme' is:

(a) Homi Bhabha (b) Vikram Sarabhai
(c) Satish Dhawan (d) A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

Answer: (b) ISRO was formed on 15 August 1969.

Q580. The 'father of the computer' is:

(a) Alan Turing (b) Charles Babbage
(c) John von Neumann (d) Bill Gates

Answer: (b) Analytical Engine; Ada Lovelace was the first programmer.

Q581. The World Wide Web was invented by:

(a) Vint Cerf (b) Tim Berners-Lee
(c) Bill Gates (d) Ray Tomlinson

Answer: (b) 1989, at CERN.

Q582. Which of these is volatile memory?

(a) ROM (b) RAM
(c) Hard disk (d) Flash drive

Answer: (b) RAM loses data when power is switched off.

Q583. The telephone was invented by:

(a) Thomas Edison (b) Alexander Graham Bell
(c) Marconi (d) Nikola Tesla

Answer: (b) 1876.

CHAPTER 11

Part B – Five GA Mock Sets (2026 Pattern)

Each set has 25 questions in the 2026 CGL proportion (science and static GK heavy, polity/history/economy/geography mixed). Time yourself: 15 minutes per set, +2 for a right answer, −0.50 for a wrong one.

Mock Set 1

Q584. Who among the following was the founder of the Satavahana dynasty?

(a) Gautamiputra Satakarni (b) Simuka
(c) Kharavela (d) Rudradaman

Answer: (b) Gautamiputra Satakarni was its greatest ruler; capital Pratishthana (Paithan).

Q585. Which Article deals with the Attorney General of India?

(a) Article 66 (b) Article 76
(c) Article 148 (d) Article 165

Answer: (b) Article 165 – Advocate General of a state.

Q586. The Kakatiya Rudreshwara (Ramappa) Temple, a UNESCO site, is in:

(a) Karnataka (b) Telangana
(c) Andhra Pradesh (d) Maharashtra

Answer: (b) Palampet; inscribed in 2021.

Q587. Which gas is mostly responsible for the greenhouse effect by volume of human emissions?

(a) Methane (b) Carbon dioxide
(c) Nitrous oxide (d) Ozone

Answer: (b) Methane is more potent per molecule but emitted in smaller amounts.

Q588. The instrument used to measure relative humidity is the:

(a) Hydrometer (b) Hygrometer
(c) Hypsometer (d) Anemometer

Answer: (b) Hydrometer – density of liquids; anemometer – wind speed.

Q589. Which vitamin is also known as tocopherol?

(a) Vitamin A (b) Vitamin D
(c) Vitamin E (d) Vitamin K

Answer: (c) An antioxidant ('anti-sterility vitamin').

Q590. The Second Battle of Panipat took place in:

(a) 1526 (b) 1556
(c) 1576 (d) 1761

Answer: (b) Akbar (with Bairam Khan) defeated Hemu.

Q591. In which state is the Bhitarkanika mangrove ecosystem?

(a) West Bengal (b) Odisha
(c) Andhra Pradesh (d) Gujarat

Answer: (b) Famous for saltwater crocodiles.

Q592. Repo rate is the rate at which:

(a) Banks lend to customers (b) RBI lends to commercial banks
(c) RBI borrows from banks (d) Government borrows from RBI

Answer: (b) A higher repo rate makes borrowing costlier and tames inflation.

Q593. Kathakali make-up colour 'pacha' (green) depicts:

(a) Demons (b) Noble characters
(c) Women (d) Sages

Answer: (b) Kathi – arrogant villains; kari (black) – demons/hunters.

Q594. The chemical name of common salt is:

(a) Sodium carbonate (b) Sodium chloride
(c) Potassium chloride (d) Calcium chloride

Answer: (b) NaCl.

Q595. The headquarters of the World Health Organization is in:

(a) New York (b) Geneva
(c) Vienna (d) Paris

Answer: (b) Founded 7 April 1948 (World Health Day).

Q596. Which is the smallest bone in the human body?

(a) Incus (b) Malleus
(c) Stapes (d) Femur

Answer: (c) In the middle ear.

Q597. Tansen was a court musician of:

(a) Babur (b) Akbar
(c) Jahangir (d) Shah Jahan

Answer: (b) One of Akbar's Navaratnas; born near Gwalior.

Q598. The Kosi river is a tributary of the:

(a) Yamuna (b) Ganga
(c) Brahmaputra (d) Son

Answer: (b) 'Sorrow of Bihar'.

Q599. Which of the following is NOT a Fundamental Right?

(a) Right to equality (b) Right to property
(c) Right against exploitation (d) Right to freedom of religion

Answer: (b) Now a legal right (Article 300A).

Q600. Electric current is measured by:

(a) Voltmeter (b) Ammeter
(c) Galvanometer only (d) Ohmmeter

Answer: (b) An ammeter is connected in series.

Q601. 'Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it' was said by:

(a) Gokhale (b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(c) Lala Lajpat Rai (d) Bipin Chandra Pal

Answer: (b) Tilak ran the newspapers Kesari and Maratha.

Q602. Which planet is called the 'Red Planet'?

(a) Venus (b) Mars
(c) Jupiter (d) Mercury

Answer: (b) Due to iron oxide; moons Phobos and Deimos.

Q603. The Indian Navy Day is observed on:

(a) 15 January (b) 4 December
(c) 8 October (d) 7 December

Answer: (b) Operation Trident (1971). Army Day – 15 Jan; Air Force Day – 8 Oct.

Q604. Which state has the largest area in India?

(a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Rajasthan
(c) Maharashtra (d) Uttar Pradesh

Answer: (b) Goa is the smallest state.

Q605. Hemis Festival is celebrated in:

(a) Sikkim (b) Ladakh
(c) Arunachal Pradesh (d) Himachal Pradesh

Answer: (b) Honours Guru Padmasambhava; masked Cham dances.

Q606. The 'Black Pagoda' is the name of:

(a) Jagannath Temple (b) Konark Sun Temple
(c) Lingaraja Temple (d) Meenakshi Temple

Answer: (b) Jagannath Temple, Puri is the 'White Pagoda'.

Q607. Which acid is present in lemon?

(a) Malic acid (b) Citric acid
(c) Tartaric acid (d) Oxalic acid

Answer: (b) Also in oranges.

Q608. The Lok Sabha's maximum strength as per the Constitution is:

(a) 545 (b) 550
(c) 552 (d) 560

Answer: (c) Article 81; currently 543 elected seats.

Mock Set 2

Q609. Who founded the Gupta era?

(a) Sri Gupta (b) Chandragupta I
(c) Samudragupta (d) Skandagupta

Answer: (b) Gupta era starts 319–320 CE; married Lichchhavi princess Kumaradevi.

Q610. The Chief Election Commissioner can be removed in the same manner as a:

(a) Union Minister (b) Supreme Court judge
(c) Governor (d) Speaker

Answer: (b) By Parliament on proved misbehaviour or incapacity.

Q611. 'Pongal' is a harvest festival of:

(a) Kerala (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) Karnataka (d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: (b) January; Jallikattu is held during it.

Q612. Which blood cells help in clotting?

(a) RBCs (b) WBCs
(c) Platelets (d) Plasma cells

Answer: (c) Thrombocytes; count falls in dengue.

Q613. The Dudhsagar waterfall is located in:

(a) Karnataka (b) Goa
(c) Kerala (d) Maharashtra

Answer: (b) On the Mandovi river, Goa–Karnataka border.

Q614. Which metal is used in making the filament of an electric heater (heating element)?

(a) Tungsten (b) Nichrome alloy
(c) Copper (d) Aluminium

Answer: (b) High resistivity; does not oxidise easily.

Q615. The Battle of Buxar was fought in:

(a) 1757 (b) 1764
(c) 1765 (d) 1799

Answer: (b) Led to the Treaty of Allahabad (1765).

Q616. Which organisation publishes the World Development Report?

(a) IMF (b) World Bank
(c) UNDP (d) WTO

Answer: (b) IMF publishes the World Economic Outlook; UNDP the Human Development Report.

Q617. Which instrument is used to measure atmospheric pressure?

(a) Hygrometer (b) Barometer
(c) Altimeter (d) Manometer

Answer: (b) Invented by Torricelli.

Q618. Kuchipudi's 'Tarangam' involves dancing on:

(a) A drum (b) The rim of a brass plate
(c) A rope (d) Sticks

Answer: (b) Often balancing a water pot on the head.

Q619. Which gas is known as marsh gas?

(a) Ethane (b) Methane
(c) Propane (d) Butane

Answer: (b) Produced in marshy areas by decaying organic matter.

Q620. Who wrote the Indian National Anthem?

(a) Bankim Chandra Chatterjee (b) Rabindranath Tagore
(c) Muhammad Iqbal (d) Sarojini Naidu

Answer: (b) Jana Gana Mana; first sung on 27 December 1911.

Q621. Which part of the eye gives it its colour?

(a) Retina (b) Iris
(c) Cornea (d) Pupil

Answer: (b) The iris controls the size of the pupil.

Q622. The Sun Temple at Modhera was built by the:

(a) Chalukyas of Badami (b) Solankis
(c) Rashtrakutas (d) Paramaras

Answer: (b) Bhima I, 11th century, Gujarat.

Q623. Loktak Lake is in:

(a) Mizoram (b) Manipur
(c) Nagaland (d) Tripura

Answer: (b) Famous for phumdis (floating vegetation).

Q624. The minimum age to become the Prime Minister of India (as a Lok Sabha member) is:

(a) 21 (b) 25
(c) 30 (d) 35

Answer: (b) A PM from the Rajya Sabha must be at least 30.

Q625. Which is a non-renewable source of energy?

(a) Solar (b) Wind
(c) Coal (d) Tidal

Answer: (c) Fossil fuels take millions of years to form.

Q626. The Ellora caves belong to which state?

(a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Maharashtra
(c) Karnataka (d) Odisha

Answer: (b) Buddhist, Hindu and Jain caves; UNESCO site.

Q627. The 'Do or Die' call was given at:

(a) Calcutta (b) Bombay
(c) Lahore (d) Wardha

Answer: (b) Gowalia Tank (August Kranti Maidan), 8 August 1942.

Q628. Which of the following is a rabi crop?

(a) Paddy (b) Maize
(c) Wheat (d) Cotton

Answer: (c) Sown October–December, harvested March–April.

Q629. The SI unit of electric charge is:

(a) Ampere (b) Coulomb
(c) Volt (d) Ohm

Answer: (b) 1 C = 1 A·s.

Q630. The International Court of Justice is located at:

(a) Geneva (b) The Hague
(c) New York (d) Vienna

Answer: (b) 15 judges with 9-year terms.

Q631. Which hormone regulates sleep–wake cycles?

(a) Thyroxine (b) Melatonin
(c) Insulin (d) Adrenaline

Answer: (b) Secreted by the pineal gland.

Q632. Which state is known as the 'Spice Garden of India'?

(a) Karnataka (b) Kerala
(c) Tamil Nadu (d) Assam

Answer: (b) Famous for pepper and cardamom.

Q633. Cheraw dance is performed with:

(a) Swords (b) Bamboo poles
(c) Drums (d) Masks

Answer: (b) Mizoram.

Mock Set 3

Q634. The Ajanta caves are famous for their:

(a) Sculptures only (b) Paintings
(c) Stupas only (d) Inscriptions

Answer: (b) Mostly Buddhist murals of the Gupta–Vakataka period.

Q635. Which Article provides for the Comptroller and Auditor General?

(a) Article 124 (b) Article 148
(c) Article 280 (d) Article 315

Answer: (b) Reports go to the President, who lays them before Parliament.

Q636. The ozone layer protects us from:

(a) Infrared rays (b) Ultraviolet rays
(c) Gamma rays only (d) Microwaves

Answer: (b) CFCs deplete it; Montreal Protocol 1987.

Q637. The State of Haryana was formed in:

(a) 1960 (b) 1966
(c) 1971 (d) 1956

Answer: (b) Carved out of Punjab on 1 November 1966.

Q638. Which vitamin deficiency causes pernicious anaemia?

(a) Vitamin B1 (b) Vitamin B6
(c) Vitamin B12 (d) Vitamin C

Answer: (c) Cobalamin; found mainly in animal products.

Q639. Sardar Sarovar Dam is built on the:

(a) Tapi (b) Narmada
(c) Mahi (d) Sabarmati

Answer: (b) Gujarat; Statue of Unity stands nearby.

Q640. Who was the Governor-General when the Indian Councils Act 1861 was passed?

(a) Lord Canning (b) Lord Elgin
(c) Lord Lawrence (d) Lord Mayo

Answer: (a) Introduced the portfolio system.

Q641. Which instrument measures the intensity of earthquakes?

(a) Barometer (b) Seismograph
(c) Altimeter (d) Odometer

Answer: (b) Magnitude is expressed on the Richter scale.

Q642. The process of conversion of sugar into alcohol by yeast is called:

(a) Distillation (b) Fermentation
(c) Oxidation (d) Hydrolysis

Answer: (b) Also produces CO_2.

Q643. Which is the national tree of India?

(a) Peepal (b) Banyan
(c) Neem (d) Ashoka

Answer: (b) Ficus benghalensis.

Q644. Which state has the highest population as per Census 2011?

(a) Maharashtra (b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Bihar (d) West Bengal

Answer: (b) Sikkim has the lowest.

Q645. The book 'Arthashastra' deals with:

(a) Astronomy (b) Statecraft and economics
(c) Medicine (d) Grammar

Answer: (b) Written by Kautilya (Chanakya).

Q646. Which planet has the most prominent ring system?

(a) Jupiter (b) Saturn
(c) Uranus (d) Neptune

Answer: (b) Saturn is also the least dense planet.

Q647. The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act was passed in:

(a) 2004 (b) 2005
(c) 2006 (d) 2009

Answer: (b) Implemented from 2 February 2006.

Q648. Which element is essential for the formation of haemoglobin?

(a) Calcium (b) Iron
(c) Iodine (d) Sodium

Answer: (b) Deficiency causes anaemia.

Q649. Mohiniyattam is a classical dance of:

(a) Tamil Nadu (b) Kerala
(c) Karnataka (d) Odisha

Answer: (b) Solo female lasya dance.

Q650. The Rowlatt Act was passed in:

(a) 1915 (b) 1919
(c) 1922 (d) 1930

Answer: (b) Allowed detention without trial; 'no vakil, no daleel, no appeal'.

Q651. Which is the largest planet in the solar system?

(a) Saturn (b) Jupiter
(c) Neptune (d) Earth

Answer: (b) Great Red Spot; fastest rotation.

Q652. Which of the following is an example of a chemical change?

(a) Melting of ice (b) Rusting of iron
(c) Dissolving sugar (d) Breaking glass

Answer: (b) New substance (iron oxide) forms.

Q653. 'Vande Mataram' was first sung at the INC session of:

(a) 1885 (b) 1896
(c) 1905 (d) 1911

Answer: (b) Calcutta, by Rabindranath Tagore.

Q654. Which UT has two capitals (summer and winter)?

(a) Ladakh (b) Jammu and Kashmir
(c) Puducherry (d) Delhi

Answer: (b) Srinagar (summer), Jammu (winter).

Q655. The Gaganyaan mission aims to:

(a) Land on Mars (b) Send Indian astronauts to space
(c) Study the Sun (d) Map the ocean floor

Answer: (b) India's first human spaceflight programme.

Q656. Which gland is called the 'third eye'?

(a) Pituitary (b) Pineal
(c) Thyroid (d) Thymus

Answer: (b) Produces melatonin.

Q657. The 'Golden Revolution' is associated with:

(a) Oilseeds (b) Horticulture and honey
(c) Fish (d) Eggs

Answer: (b) Yellow – oilseeds; Blue – fish; Silver – eggs.

Q658. Who was the first Indian woman to win an Olympic silver medal?

(a) Saina Nehwal (b) P.V. Sindhu
(c) Mirabai Chanu (d) Sakshi Malik

Answer: (b) Badminton, Rio 2016.

Mock Set 4

Q659. Who among the following was the founder of the Slave dynasty?

(a) Iltutmish (b) Qutbuddin Aibak
(c) Balban (d) Razia

Answer: (b) 1206; known as 'Lakh Bakhsh'.

Q660. Which Schedule of the Constitution deals with the administration of tribal areas in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram?

(a) Fifth (b) Sixth
(c) Seventh (d) Ninth

Answer: (b) Autonomous district councils.

Q661. The Statue of Unity commemorates:

(a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
(c) B.R. Ambedkar (d) Subhas Chandra Bose

Answer: (b) 182 m, Kevadia, Gujarat – the world's tallest statue.

Q662. Which gas do plants absorb during photosynthesis?

(a) Oxygen (b) Carbon dioxide
(c) Nitrogen (d) Hydrogen

Answer: (b) And release oxygen.

Q663. The Siachen Glacier lies in the:

(a) Zaskar Range (b) Karakoram Range
(c) Pir Panjal Range (d) Shiwalik Range

Answer: (b) Ladakh; one of the longest non-polar glaciers.

Q664. Which disease is caused by the deficiency of insulin?

(a) Diabetes insipidus (b) Diabetes mellitus
(c) Goitre (d) Addison's disease

Answer: (b) Diabetes insipidus is due to ADH deficiency.

Q665. The term 'Googly' is associated with:

(a) Hockey (b) Cricket
(c) Football (d) Tennis

Answer: (b) A delivery by a leg-spinner that turns the other way.

Q666. Which Five-Year Plan was terminated a year early?

(a) Third (b) Fourth
(c) Fifth (d) Sixth

Answer: (c) Fifth Plan (1974–78), by the Janata government.

Q667. Sound waves are:

(a) Transverse (b) Longitudinal (in air)
(c) Electromagnetic (d) Stationary only

Answer: (b) They travel as compressions and rarefactions.

Q668. The 'Champaran Satyagraha' was against:

(a) Salt tax (b) Indigo plantation (tinkathia system)
(c) Land revenue in Gujarat (d) Rowlatt Act

Answer: (b) 1917, Bihar.

Q669. Which mineral is used in making aluminium?

(a) Haematite (b) Bauxite
(c) Galena (d) Mica

Answer: (b) Odisha is the largest producer.

Q670. Which festival is celebrated as the Assamese New Year?

(a) Bhogali Bihu (b) Rongali (Bohag) Bihu
(c) Kati Bihu (d) Ambubachi

Answer: (b) Mid-April.

Q671. The SI unit of power is:

(a) Joule (b) Watt
(c) Newton (d) Pascal

Answer: (b) 1 W = 1 J/s; 1 hp ≈ 746 W.

Q672. The headquarters of the Asian Development Bank is in:

(a) Beijing (b) Manila
(c) Tokyo (d) Jakarta

Answer: (b) Established 1966. AIIB – Beijing.

Q673. Which organ produces bile?

(a) Pancreas (b) Liver
(c) Gall bladder (d) Spleen

Answer: (b) Stored and concentrated in the gall bladder.

Q674. The 'Black Death' refers to:

(a) Cholera (b) Plague
(c) Smallpox (d) Leprosy

Answer: (b) Caused by Yersinia pestis, spread by rat fleas.

Q675. Kathak is mainly associated with:

(a) South India (b) North India
(c) North-East India (d) East India

Answer: (b) The only classical dance of the north; Mughal influence.

Q676. Which Article guarantees equality before law?

(a) Article 14 (b) Article 15
(c) Article 16 (d) Article 19

Answer: (a) Equality before law and equal protection of laws.

Q677. The Indus Waters Treaty was signed in:

(a) 1950 (b) 1960
(c) 1965 (d) 1972

Answer: (b) Between India and Pakistan, brokered by the World Bank.

Q678. Which is the largest desert in the world (including cold deserts)?

(a) Sahara (b) Antarctica
(c) Gobi (d) Arabian

Answer: (b) The Sahara is the largest hot desert.

Q679. 'Gross Domestic Product' measures:

(a) Production by citizens anywhere (b) Production within the country's borders
(c) Only agricultural output (d) Exports minus imports

Answer: (b) GNP adds net factor income from abroad.

Q680. Which is known as the 'Manchester of India'?

(a) Kanpur (b) Ahmedabad
(c) Coimbatore (d) Surat

Answer: (b) Kanpur is the 'Manchester of UP'; Coimbatore of South India.

Q681. Who discovered radioactivity?

(a) Marie Curie (b) Henri Becquerel
(c) Rutherford (d) Röntgen

Answer: (b) 1896; shared the 1903 Nobel with the Curies.

Q682. The National Voters' Day is observed on:

(a) 26 January (b) 25 January
(c) 24 January (d) 15 August

Answer: (b) Foundation day of the Election Commission (1950).

Q683. Which dance form uses 'chakkars' (spins) prominently?

(a) Bharatanatyam (b) Kathak
(c) Odissi (d) Manipuri

Answer: (b) Fast footwork with ghungroos.

Mock Set 5

Q684. The Ashokan inscription that mentions his name 'Ashoka' directly is at:

(a) Sarnath (b) Maski
(c) Lumbini (d) Girnar

Answer: (b) Most edicts call him 'Devanampiya Piyadasi'.

Q685. Which Constitutional Amendment created the National Commission for Backward Classes?

(a) 101st (b) 102nd
(c) 103rd (d) 104th

Answer: (b) 2018; Article 338B.

Q686. Which Indian state shares borders with the maximum number of states?

(a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Assam (d) Maharashtra

Answer: (b) UP borders 8 states plus Delhi (NCT).

Q687. The chemical formula of quicklime is:

(a) $CaCO_3$ (b) CaO
(c) $Ca(OH)_2$ (d) $CaSO_4$

Answer: (b) $Ca(OH)_2$ is slaked lime.

Q688. Which part of the plant conducts water?

(a) Phloem (b) Xylem
(c) Cambium (d) Cortex

Answer: (b) Mostly dead tissue (vessels, tracheids).

Q689. The famous 'Lucknow Pact' (1916) was between:

(a) INC and Muslim League (b) Moderates and British
(c) Gandhi and Ambedkar (d) INC and Swaraj Party

Answer: (a) Also reunited Moderates and Extremists.

Q690. Which is the deepest lake in the world?

(a) Caspian Sea (b) Lake Baikal
(c) Lake Superior (d) Lake Tanganyika

Answer: (b) Siberia, Russia; also the oldest freshwater lake.

Q691. Who is the author of 'The Guide'?

(a) Raja Rao (b) R.K. Narayan
(c) Mulk Raj Anand (d) Anita Desai

Answer: (b) Sahitya Akademi Award 1960.

Q692. Which of the following is a non-metal that conducts electricity?

(a) Sulphur (b) Graphite
(c) Phosphorus (d) Iodine

Answer: (b) Free electrons between its layers.

Q693. Which disease is known as 'break-bone fever'?

(a) Malaria (b) Dengue
(c) Chikungunya (d) Typhoid

Answer: (b) Severe joint and muscle pain.

Q694. In which year was the Reserve Bank of India nationalised?

(a) 1935 (b) 1947
(c) 1949 (d) 1969

Answer: (c) 1 January 1949.

Q695. Which is the national river of India?

(a) Yamuna (b) Ganga
(c) Godavari (d) Brahmaputra

Answer: (b) Declared in 2008.

Q696. Light travels fastest in:

(a) Water (b) Glass
(c) Vacuum (d) Diamond

Answer: (c) About 3×10^8 m/s.

Q697. Which of these is a Mughal-period text on Islamic law?

(a) Ain-i-Akbari (b) Fatawa-e-Alamgiri
(c) Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri (d) Padshahnama

Answer: (b) Compiled under Aurangzeb.

Q698. The 'Ten Degree Channel' lies between:

(a) Lakshadweep and Maldives (b) Little Andaman and Car Nicobar
(c) India and Sri Lanka (d) Minicoy and Kavaratti

Answer: (b) Separates the Andaman and Nicobar groups.

Q699. The father of the Green Revolution in India is:

(a) Norman Borlaug (b) M.S. Swaminathan
(c) Verghese Kurien (d) C. Subramaniam

Answer: (b) Borlaug is the global father of the Green Revolution.

Q700. Which writ is issued by a higher court to quash the order of a lower court?

(a) Mandamus (b) Certiorari
(c) Prohibition (d) Habeas Corpus

Answer: (b) Prohibition stops a pending proceeding; certiorari quashes a decided one.

Q701. Which acid is found in apples?

(a) Malic acid (b) Citric acid
(c) Acetic acid (d) Lactic acid

Answer: (a) Tartaric – grapes, tamarind.

Q702. Which of these is a folk dance of Punjab?

(a) Garba (b) Bhangra
(c) Bihu (d) Lavani

Answer: (b) Giddha is the women's dance of Punjab.

Q703. The International Day of Yoga is observed on:

(a) 21 March (b) 21 June
(c) 5 June (d) 1 July

Answer: (b) Since 2015, proposed by India at the UN.

Q704. Which part of the brain controls involuntary actions like breathing?

(a) Cerebrum (b) Cerebellum
(c) Medulla oblongata (d) Thalamus

Answer: (c) Also controls heartbeat, coughing, vomiting.

Q705. The 'Swadeshi Movement' began in response to the:

(a) Rowlatt Act (b) Partition of Bengal
(c) Jallianwala Bagh massacre (d) Simon Commission

Answer: (b) 1905; boycott of British goods.

Q706. The 'Bharatanatyam' dance originated in:

(a) Kerala (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) Andhra Pradesh (d) Karnataka

Answer: (b) Earlier called Sadir; revived by Rukmini Devi Arundale.

Q707. Which unit is used to measure the power of a lens?

(a) Watt (b) Dioptre
(c) Lux (d) Lumen

Answer: (b) P = 1/f (m).

Q708. The headquarters of ISRO is located in:

(a) Thiruvananthapuram (b) Bengaluru
(c) Sriharikota (d) Ahmedabad

Answer: (b) Launch site – Sriharikota; VSSC – Thiruvananthapuram.